

Ashapura Minechem (ASHAPURMIN)

Conference call transcripts, oldest-first. 3 call(s). Generated 2026-06-08.

Call: Sep 2025

Ref No.: Minechem/Stock Exch/Letter/ 8376 September 09, 2025

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Scrip Code: 527001 Scrip Code: ASHAPURMIN

Dear Sir/Madam,

Sub.: Disclosure under Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 – Transcript of Maiden Earnings Conference Call with analysts/ investors.

This is in continuation to our letters dated 28th August, 2025 and 04th September, 2025.

Pursuant to Regulations 30 read with Para A of Part A of Schedule III and other applicable provisions of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, as amended, we attach herewith the transcript of Maiden Earnings Conference Call to discuss the operational and financial performance of the Company for Q1-FY2026. held on 04th September 2025. The transcript is also uploaded in the Company's website <https://www.ashapura.com/shareholder-information.php>.

Kindly take the above information on records.
Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,
For Ashapura Minechem Ltd.,

Sachin Polke
Company Secretary & President (Corporate Affairs)

"Ashapura Minechem Limited
Q1 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call"
September 04, 2025

M
MANAGEMENT : MR. CHETAN SHAH – CHAIRMAN – ASHAPURA GROUP
MR. MANAN SHAH – PROMOTER GROUP – ASHAPURA
MINECHEM LIMITED
MR. ASHISH DESAI – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
ASHAPURA MINECHEM LIMITED
MR. HEMUL SHAH – EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR – ASHAPURA
MINECHEM LIMITED
MR. SACHIN POLKE – COMPANY SECRETARY AND
PRESIDENT , CORPORATE AFFAIRS – ASHAPURA
MINECHEM LIMITED

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Ashapura Mine chem Limited Q1 FY26 Earnings Conference Call . As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star and then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded. This conference call may contain forward -looking statements about the company which are based on the beliefs, opinions and expectations of the company as on date of this call. These statements are not the guarantee of future performance and involve risks and uncertainties that are difficult to predict.

On the call we have with us Mr. Chetan Shah, Chairman, Mr. Manan Shah, Promoter Group, Mr. Ashish Desai, Chief Financial Officer, Mr. Hemul Shah, Executive Director, Mr. Sachin Polke, Company Secretary and President, Corporate Affairs. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Chetan Shah, Chairman, Ashapura Mine chem Limited. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Chetan Shah: Good afternoon, friends. I am Chetan Shah, Chairman of Ashapura Group. I would like to welcome all of you for joining this earning call which is really a maiden call for Ashapura Group and I really appreciate all of you for joining this call and giving your time to listen to Ashapura and Ashapura's current activities.

I have with me our CFO, Ashish Desai, our Company Secretary, Mr. Sachin Polke, our Executive Director Hem ul Shah and also Manan Shah who is from the Promoter Group. I am also very thankful for Adfactors for taking us a lot of trouble for organizing this call. So I am very thankful to them also for joining for this call.

When we discuss about the Ashapura, I would like to as we have already circulated our current activities, the note with you all along with our quarterly results and in that notes we have given a fair details about our current activities and our future plans. Today, I get an opportunity to speak to you about how the Ashapura is working and what is our plans in coming years. If you want, like we can divide the Ashapura in two parts.

One is the part is that Ashapura India Operation and Ashapura International Operations. First, let me start with Ashapura India Operations. In 1982, we started with a very modest beginning and company was incorporated and just it was a single product company.

We started with bentonite. Today, Ashapura has got a very wide mineral portfolio, and we have become from the single product company to multi minerals, multi solutions company. For that, few things which I would really like to mention here.

Our Indian operations, when we have seen that there is a lot of limitations in getting the new mineral resources and also there is a prolonged delay in getting the mining concessions, we have decided that

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in India, we will go for more on the value added mineral products rather than going for the bulk exports. It was very conscious strategy was made and we started implementing this strategy where we are going for more for value rather than volume and this strategy has worked very well . And the result of that today Ashapura is the largest bentonite producer in India and third largest in the world. From bentonite, we are making the bentonite derivatives called bleaching clay.

Also, we are the largest producer of bleaching clay in India and again third largest producer of bleaching clay in the world. Today, our bleaching clay plant have a capacity to produce 200,000 tons and it is the largest plant in the world located at single locations. Similarly, coming to bentonite, we have the capacity to produce 700,000 tons of bentonite, processed bentonite and that is

also at single locations which is the largest again in the world.

Similarly, we are the largest producer of kaolin in India. Similarly, we also produce largest producer of industrial ceramic materials having the kind of the plant which is called the producing the propens which is the first plant of its kind in India. And similarly, in many other areas, we are leading in the country and also we have recognized as the manufacturers or the suppliers in the globally.

So this strategy of using the minimum minerals and creating the maximum value has really played a very important role in our Indian operations. We are expanding these Indian operations gradually and I can say that we are getting a very, very good response for all our minerals or the mineral added value added products across the globe. Today, Ashapura Indian operations are exporting more than 80 countries of their processed minerals or mineral products and this is very significant.

The most important thing is that all our value added products, we are using the raw materials which is coming from our own mining source. The proximity between the mines to the plant to the main seaport is all in 100 kilometer radius which is a very rare kind of a thing anywhere in any part of the world. So, this is the biggest advantage what Ashapura has got, and we created such kind of facilities at gradually developing and still putting up the more and more efforts to increase our product

capacity.

After talking about the Indian operations, we have thought that now the India is very limited, the scope for Ashapura if we have to grow very fast . And for that we have started looking at the opportunity across the globe. We have tried at the different countries like Oman, Sudan, Egypt, Madagascar and so on and finally Ashapura is settled in Guinea which is situated on the West Coast of Africa and Guinea is the country where the largest bauxite reserves is available in the world. We went to Guinea in 2016 . And since 2016 in last 11 years , we are working in Guinea to get various concessions for mining of bauxite and also iron ore.

At the moment , we have got three concessions for the mining of bauxite, and our total reserves of bauxite is in excess of 700 million tons . And at the same time, we also won concessions for mining of iron ore where the reserves are more than 300 million tons. The journey was a long journey for Ashapura a Minechem Limited
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last 11 years and now we have fairly established in Guinea for excavations and export of bauxite as well as iron ore.

Coming back to the bauxite , as you have seen that in the last quarters , we have exported more than 2 million tons of bauxite and this is the highest in the history of the company just doing such volume in the one quarter and we expect that we will continue this kind of momentum for time to come.

Guinea is blessed with the very high-quality bauxite and it's the proximity to the seaport is varies from 50 kilometers to 120 kilometers. We have built three new ports in Guinea. We have built more than 300 kilometers of high-quality heavy truck kind of roads, and we also built more than 100 kilometers of the mining roads within the mining areas.

These concessions are in few square kilometers so there is a lot of development is required for the infrastructures because Guinea government gives you mining concessions , but they don't provide you any kind of infrastructure support which every mining or mine owner has to provide their own.

This is the one reason when we started investing in Guinea and we could see almost you can say the period of eight to nine years , we are continuously investing in this territory and finally now we have started getting some results out of it. Our ports capacity we can handle currently about 16 million tons of bauxite which we will, enhancing our capacity over a time so that in future it can handle at least

about more than 20 million tons of products.

Our mining capacity is also we have increased and so that we can produce minerals to match with our export capabilities.

Lately , we have done a very strong or you can say long-term partnership with some of the Chinese major who have the ability to go for the contract mining, the contract transportations and the handlings and also they were going to have the investment in these projects so that we can enhance our capacity and it will remain a long -term , a reliable -- Ashapura can remain a long -term reliable supplier of bauxite which we are very ambitious to have a kind of volume to come in next three years ' time.

Guinea journey was not very simple . We have put a lot of efforts and today you can say that only one company -- 90% of the business has been done by mostly Chinese company . Ashapura is only one company who have now sustainable a kind of standing in Guinea and now we recognize as a supplier of bauxite as well as iron ore that took us a very long, long journey.

Why we selected a kind of a country ? The reason is that we had very limited resources, and we had like unlimited ambitions , so it is a very high risk , high reward kind of a territory. We have selected these things, and I can say that as on today, it looks that we are fairly successful in this selection process. We also like to have a look at the different minerals the country is blessed ; Guinea is blessed with a few other minerals . But as on today, it is all at on the study levels or you can say more is on academic purpose. We are not that thing , but it gives us a future opportunity to think on this land.

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So after saying that this for the Guinea or the after saying for this for India , Ashapura is -- I just have a few words about a very small , very modest success but there are the few reasons behind this success. One of them is that the value chain what we are creating for which we are depending our own in-house minerals , more than 90 % of the minerals is come from our own mines and it goes to our own processing facilities and ultimately converting into the products.

Sometimes the value addition is such , I just give a one very simple example that the Bentonite basically you can say that it's a \$ 40 FOB business we are converting into the bleaching clay which is more than \$ 400 per ton product. So now we are going for that thing . And secondly, we are going for creating different options to replace the high- value product or high- value materials with the low cost products. So this is one of the area where we also focus.

When I say that in the few things about our success in this business, the second important thing is that we have the state-of-the-art R&D -- which is spread over about 12 acres of land and we have more than 75 scientists to work for our R&D centers.

These R&D centers give us the support for creating the new products, for the new applications and also how we can rationalize or standardize our costing while producing these kind of products. Lot of our products like Organoclay, for example proppants, for example the Bentonite for the detergent applications, Bentonite for the animal feed applications. These are few examples. This is all the products which has come from our R&D sites.

Our R&D is one of the very active R&D and I am very proud to say that such kind of R&D is rare in the size of our size of companies. It is very few companies who has got such kind of setup. This is giving us a lot of support for creating the new products and the new value additions.

Besides R&D, another important resource which we have is the human resource. Ashapura has more than 2200 people working on our payrolls. They are very strong, dedicated teams who are based in all our locations, and they are taking care of the business and the business

developments.

Ashapura's attrition rate is very low. The tenure of the people is more than 10 years to 15 years in the company and I can treat that it is one of the most important resource we are having and you can say besides our mineral resource, the human resource is the second important resource we have in Ashapura.

At the same time, we follow the good corporate governance and try to create the maximum transparency in our operations, in our declarations. All kinds of things are happening which is to be made available at large so that the people can understand, the investor can understand and we also feel very comfortable to declare all the information.

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So this is the area which has a few things which we feel that these are the part of Ashapura's current story. I once again like to thank you all and if you feel that you have any questions related with our presentations or our -- this is not basically, we are just looking for that.

We are not going to get you the numbers where we are going to be in the next or there is no guidance in this call. So only we prefer to introduce our company and to make sure that this company has a very strong future and the reason is that in the world, you know like the kind of company who has such a large mineral basket, who have so many mineral-based solutions for the different kind of applications which is again, it's very rare. If you can look at that thing, you know in the mid-size of company, this kind of thing is very rare.

And last thing which I would like to add that currently, the Guinea is our major focus area which contributes more than 70% of our revenue on top line and as well as in bottom line. Guinea's future is associated with the bauxite and the bauxite is becoming one of the very rare minerals as the aluminum metal, the consumption of the metals is increasing almost 5% to 6% per annum and it's going to increase much higher than 5% to 6% in time to come because of the lot of new applications like for especially for the EV kind of vehicles.

Just very recently, I was reading about that most of the solar panels, the frames are made out of the aluminum. The latest research is happening in this aluminum salt batteries which is going to replace gradually, but it's going to replace the lithium batteries. Aluminum metal is going to remain very strong in demand because one of the metals is very stable metal and the availability of the raw material is also very stable.

So, I can feel that and the Guinea, luckily, we have those of the bauxite. So, if you combine all these factors together, you can see that the company has a very long-term future. So, we are not here and just discussing the numbers of the quarter or something, but we are looking that the many more such quarters to happen in future and we really appreciate all our stakeholders or maybe future stakeholders who are joining for this call and giving us a lot of encouragement, lot of motivations and lot of inspirations for telling our story to you.

So, once again, please accept my sincere gratitude for attending this call. Now, I would like our CFO, Mr. Ashish Desai, to have a few words or to give some numbers to you which you maybe like to have and to appreciate. Thank you. Thank you once again. Thank you very much.

Ashish Desai: Thank you, sir. Good evening, friends. Coming to our operational and financial performance, in the quarter ended June 30, 2025, we exported more than 2 million metric tons of bauxite vis-à-vis 3.37 million metric tons for the full financial year '25.

In quarter 1 of '26, we reported consolidated income from operation at INR 13.55 crores, which is a growth of 89.8% year-on-year. This was primarily driven by our operations in Guinea, leading to

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robust sales of bauxite. In fact, Guinea

business accounted for, to be precise, 79.3% of our top line in the quarter and we expect this momentum to continue.

Coming to EBITDA, for the quarter, it stood at INR 187.73 crore s, registering growth of 106.8% year-on-year. EBITDA margin also expanded by 114 basis points to 13.85% on the back of operational efficiency and economy of scale. The quarter's PBT was at INR 131.84 crore s, growing 102.5 percentage year -on-year with PBT margin of 9.73% higher by 61 basis point year -on-year. And lastly EPS for the quarter stood at INR 11.5 now I would hand over to Manan to talk about our outlook and our long-term plan s, thank you.

Manan Shah: Hi, good evening everyone . Thank you for joining us on the call today. I would like to share my outlook and the two divisions like mentioned by Chetan Shah. To start with the Guinea business we believe that we will continue to capitalize on our strong reserves and infrastructure in Guinea . As mentioned earlier we see the growth of aluminum to be around 5% to 6% at least for the next few years .

And we see that therefore the bauxite demand will also increase to that effect . Bauxite prices are expected to remain stable, and China will continue to be the world's largest consumer . Together these factors give us confidence that our Guinea operations will see steady and sustainable growth in the years ahead . At present our port capacity stands at 16 million metric ton, and we expect to reach 27 million metric tons of port capacity by quarter one FY27 .

As stated in the note earlier our target is to export 15 million tons of bauxite by FY27 -28. In parallel we are also advancing our Iron Ore business where A shapura has opted for a structured model of supplying mined ore to a local beneficiation plant . This business will gradually ramp up and is expected to contribute meaningfully to the profitability of our G uinea business .

For India business we have four factors which we see will contribute to our growth . First we expect a good organic growth itself . The reason for this is that many global supply chains are shifting toward China Plus One strategy and A shapura is a leading brand and a favorable alternate in this regard. Companies are also looking for alternates to high cost E uropean and A merican product s.

And this is something that we have been able to develop step -by-step . We see ourselves capturing a larger share of the global market over time. The second part of this growth will come from capacity enhancements . Many of our existing production capacities are close to full utilization. And we are expanding them to meet rising demand while investing in technologies to improve efficiencies .

The third area is expansion into high value d product lines . We remain focused on technology driven innovation backed by strong agile research capabilities . Our emerging product portfolio spans industries such as animal care, environmental protection , foundries , paints and coatings . These segments that we aspire to get into are technologically demanding but present significant opportunities for scale and value creation upon commercialization .

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Lastly but also equally importantly our focus remains on resource acquisition. We need to replenish the resources which is used by our company. This is the way to ensure sustainability of long-term operations and cost leadership in our segments . This is all from our side and thank you for patiently listening . We would be happy to take any questions that you may have now . Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much . We will now begin with the question and answer session. Our first question comes from the line of Naitik Mohata from Sequent Investments.

Naitik Mohata: First of all, I would like to congratulate the management on posting such good set of numbers . It seems like all the hard work over the years is starting

to pay off . Also the initiative of earnings call

that we have taken is very positive . And I hope that we would continue with this in the future as well .

My first question would be , so we have we have been investing quite some -- quite a lot in G uinea in the last four -five years . Acquiring these mines establishing roads and ports for logistic purposes and all. So what would be the total amount that we might have in vested till now in the business?

Manan Shah: Is that the only question?

Naitik Mohata: No I have a couple of follow -up questions as well .

Manan Shah: Maybe you could just say them all together is that okay?

Naitik Mohata: Okay so that would be my first question . The second question would be like with respect to the iron ore mine in G uinea . So what is the timeline and what is the progress for iron ore mine there? And how soon can we expect some numbers out of the iron ore mine as well ? And lastly the total bauxite that we can extract on the capacity is in place right now what would that look like?

Manan Shah: Okay so I'll take question two and three first . And then our CFO can handle the question on the capex.

So your first question is regarding to iron ore , in case of iron ore as we mentioned that we have a strategic agreement with particularly our local beneficiation plant . While numbers are too early to

share right now . We see that it would significantly contribute to our bottom line in due course of time.

While this business is happening close to an ex-mines rate, so in terms of top line the numbers may not be immediately visible . But over period of time we expect that it will contribute to the bottom line. Currently the business is in stage of -- last stages of development and should we expect it to start ramping up very soon. Maybe in the next quarter or two quarters , some effect of the iron ore business should be viable .

Currently we are not sharing our long -term iron ore numbers but in due course of time we shall share this. And regarding to bauxite extraction , if you can understand, so it in terms of mining . The limitations do not arise exactly in that sense . It requires the roads and the ports also to be equally

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compliant . Today our port capacity is at 16 million tons and we are as we have mentioned we expect this to go to 27 million tons .

So you can consider that our port capacity could be a factor in determining what is the maximum potential at any given point of time but however as such, with the kind of reserves we have . We have obviously the opportunity to scale up even beyond that in a longer term . Ashish Bhai on the capex?

Ashish Desai: Yes so to answer your question on how much we have invested. So we have already invested more than around \$135 million as on today.

Naitik Mohata: Okay so a follow -up on that question would be , how much would have gone in developing the mine , how much would have gone in developing the ports ? And currently also what we are planning to expand the port capacity how much we are investing to do that as well?

Manan Shah: Sir, I think currently, in the interest of the time on this call, this would be a very long conversation to have. But we do have, obviously, the breakups available with us . So that can be discussed in due course of time.

Naitik Mohata: Alright, sir? Thank you. I will join back in the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Giriraj Daga from Visaria Family Trust. Please go ahead.

Giriraj Daga: Hello team. First of all, thanks for arranging the call. I hope this remains the endeavor in the future also, that we can keep hearing the management periodically on the call. My question remains, in terms of volume. First of all, this is a two -part of the one question. First, in terms of this quarterly number of 2 million tons and the last year's num

ber mentioned of 3.77 million tons, and our guidance of 15 million tons by 2028?

Should we assume a periodic jump from 3, going to 6, then 7, then 10, then 15? Is that the journey this way ? Second, in terms of our sales tie-up, what is the mix between spot and long-term? Is it a volume fixed, price fixed, or is the price linked to the market price? How is the scenario there?

Manan Shah: So, as we have mentioned, of course there are seasons in the business where Q2 is typically affected by monsoon. But we do expect a somewhat linear growth toward our target. So, that's point one.

Second, as you mentioned about the long-term and spot business, the eventual objective is that our long-term contracts' volumes may be fixed, but the prices are depending on the index conditions. So eventually, the pricing should be in line with whatever the spot prices are as per the China market.

So, there are no fixed prices going into multiple years as on now in the bauxite contract. So, the volume contracts are available, but the pricing remains flexible as per market conditions .

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Giriraj Daga: Okay. If I can just get some follow -up there . What would be our EBITDA part we are building in , in let's say reasonable number of 7-8 million ton ?

Manan Shah: So, I think the current EBITDA , I mean it can be calculated from the volume and the EBITDA given. We have offered our division-wise financials in the investor note. You can expect that this EBITDA number could be a little better from here, but the exact guidance will not be available.

Giriraj Daga: Okay, and lastly if I can ask, what is the remaining capex in Guinea now to reach the full potential?

Manan Shah: As of now, I can share with you that most of the capex has been completed, and the company does not see a lot of significant capex going ahead. But exact numbers, again, it is tough to calculate, but I think that we have been in Guinea since 2016, and after nine long years, we are seeing some good results. So, we can say that the bulk of the capex has been factored .

Giriraj Daga: Okay, thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Sudhir Bheda from Bheda Family Office. Please go ahead.

Sudhir Bheda: Hi, good afternoon, sir. I would like to congratulate you. You have come up in the last year and

created in shareholder value, and Guinea also, the way you have performed in. So, my hearty congratulations as a shareholder. My question is, what is the plan in terms of your debt? When will the company become a debt-free level? And second, what is the plan of this year? What kind of guidance can you give for dispatches for FY26, in bauxite?

Manan Shah: Okay, so a couple of questions. First, we are not offering a yearly guidance, which is why we've given a clear guidance for FY27-28. Currently we are not offering a yearly guidance, but I can say that we expect a linear growth from our numbers now to our targeted numbers in FY27-28. So, I think that leaves enough information to kind of broadly make out what can be expected.

On the second part, on the debt, we expect EBITDA levels to be healthy or even get a little bit healthier from here which should help us over a period of time to reduce our debt. But like an exact guidance on, how much our debt may reduce further on those operations is currently not available. In our India operations, we hardly have any debt, or we have no long-term debts as such, so we are fairly comfortable.

Sudhir Bheda: Thank you, sir, for giving the opportunity to ask questions.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Keval Doshi from Onyx Capital. Please go ahead.

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Keval Doshi: Thank you for the opportunity and congratulations Chetan bhai and team for a spectacular performance. I want

to understand the ports which we built in Guinea, are these ports exclusively being used by us, under our control or there are third parties also which have access to these ports?

Manan Shah: These ports 100% belong to us, 100% operated by us and 100% utilized for our cargos. A lot of the capex which has been discussed earlier on this call has gone towards the development of these ports. As we mentioned 16 million tons of capacity has been added up by us since we ended up in Guinea and this is also one of the reasons why the project has taken such a long time to bear fruit after inception. But the ports 100% belong to us and we have our complete rights on these ports.

Keval Doshi: Okay, thank you. My next question is that, we read from the note that for five to six months, there is extreme rainfall in Guinea and therefore there could be disruptions. So, would it be a complete stoppage of excavation from the port, or would it be partially shut? What happens during these five or six months?

Manan Shah: So, typically, there is some variation in the amount of volumes we're able to execute. Not just on account of the port itself, but because of the acute rains on the mines, the road, and the entire infrastructure. Plus, the obviously bauxite gets wet, and typically wet cargo is less profitable to execute and is also a headache for the buyer.

So, you can expect some disruption, but it's hard for us to predict because it really has a lot to do with the amount of millimeter of rain which we are seeing over there. I think, maybe you can have a very approximate correlation to the rains and the kind of volumes which are there, because mining is a business, and especially in this kind of industry, where the rain will directly affect your ability to execute cargo. So, we expect some disruption. So, I think whatever our targets are, would see that quarter two would always have numbers which would be below the average. And then quarter three would see a pickup and then quarter four and quarter one would do even better. So typically, that's how I can explain it, but it really depends on the yearly, the rainfall as per the season and the severity of the rain. So it's very hard for us to predict, but we do try our best to at least execute some volumes even in the off periods and the monsoon period. So it will not happen that quarter 2 would see no exports for bauxite for example.

Keval Doshi: Okay understood. My next question and probably last is on the India business side do we expect new products to be introduced and is there any impact which we may have on if at all we are exporting to the U.S?

Manan Shah: Currently Ashapura I could say less than a fraction of a percentage of our exports from India and no exports from Guinea are to USA. So there is I would say below beyond negligible or below negligible impact of US tariffs that's one. There is no impact of that on our company. Regarding to our new product developments we are very excited and very passionately bringing in as my father explained
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in his speech the cost beating innovations for variety of material industries such as paints coatings foundries animal feed, animal care environmental protection, but these are projects which obviously will play out over a medium to longer term in terms of the company sides.

Keval Doshi: Thank you so much Manan for answering all the questions and wish you and the entire team all the very best.

Manan Shah: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Kirtan Mehta from Baroda BNP Paribas Mutual fund. Please go ahead.

Kirtan Mehta: Thank you sir for giving this opportunity. One question related to our mining business in Guinea. Based on the Q 1 numbers given appears that the our bauxite realization has been closer to around \$65 where

as a beta is around \$10, \$11 implying around \$ 55 of bauxite production and transportation cost.

Could you give us a bit more insight into our cost elements in terms of what is the mining cost what is the transportation cost, what are the port operation costs. And on the realization side you previously mentioned that we have index pricing how much proportion actually is in under a long-term contract and what is generated on the spot contract and who are our key buyers if you give some insight around the bauxite business that would be useful?

Manan Shah: Sure. So I will not be able to share with you very specific information currently, but I can tell you that typically the mining cost is the very small part of the total cost. Typically in this entire thing the mining cost may be hardly a few percentage points of the total cost. The major cost is the transportation which happens from the mines to the port and then from the port via capsized vessels to our end users mostly in china, that is a significant part of the total cost.

So that includes barging trans shippers if any and then finally the actual freight of the cargo being carried from Guinea to China. So majority of the cost involved is all related to logistics and can be a function of the performance of various sea routes in terms of how their pricing is faring is one of the basic impact of that.

So the costing is majorly on the logistics and logistics management side which is predominantly what is on the costing. Regarding your question and there are some taxes also in terms of to the government which has to be paid as royalties on the export so that also exists. So that is also as the some percentage of the total cost.

Regarding to the index pricing so the our pricing will always be linked to the index, but whether it's a premium or penalty depends customer to customer based on the grade of bauxite which they would

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be buying and the kind of moisture which is in the material, but you can understand that our EBITDA would have a some correlation to index prices.

Kirtan Mehta: Right, sir. This is quite useful and if you can also sort of suggest how the cost would change as we increase our operations how much it can come down with the increase in the size of operations?

Manan Shah: So I would give a broad based answer on that. Basically as you can understand that Ashapura is working with reputed partners to strengthen its infrastructure chain and Ashapura has a target to significantly increase its volumes. I think both those initiatives put together should see some more efficiency being unlocked, but it would be too soon for me to give a very specific number.

But you can understand from our guidance that we significantly want to ramp up the kind of volumes which we are doing today and so therefore there would be some amount of increase in efficiency

from economies of scale and as well as working with the very established partners who have their own efficiencies in handling infrastructure and logistics.

Kirtan Mehta: Sure, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Nalin Shah from NVS Brokerage. Please go ahead.

Nalin Shah: Congratulations for excellent numbers. I think most of the questions in my mind has been covered already in the decision. Only thing I would like to just ask whether any kind of acquisitions.

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt Mr. Shah you're sounding a bit muffled and how if you can just speak on the side of the speaker.

Nalin Shah: Hello. Am I audible now?

Moderator: This is much better sir. Please go ahead.

Nalin Shah: Yes. So I just only would like to know if there are any strategies or for unlocking of value what we are considering, is there any strategy or anything on the card in terms of acquisitions and inorganic growth as well as any like de -

merger or something which can create further value for the company if you can throw some light on that?

Management: Currently our company's focus remains on bringing in continued momentum to our Guinea business. And as mentioned in India we are developing new product segments. We are open to all opportunities of acquisitions or any other kind of strategic activities. However, our management focus is on the growth of both Guinea and India business as they stand for the time being.

Nalin Shah: Thank you very much.

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Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Bhavin Chheda from Enam Holdings. Please go ahead.

Bhavin Chheda: Good afternoon sir. Just few on the Guinea mines as you have given in your investor note I believe you having three concessions. So are all these can you also give the mine life or the concession period and are all these three concessions or three mining areas currently operational because your 700 million reserves seems to be spread over three mines of HUDA, BOF FA and FAKO.

Manan Shah: Okay. Good questions. So we have a basically a 15 years plus 15 years renewable lease on these assets and then those are also of course 30 years later I am not sure what I can predict after 30 years, but our contract is for 15 plus 15 on these mines and two of these mines are operational as mentioned in our note and one is under development so that status still stands.

Bhavin Chheda: And the first 15 years starts from 2016 so renewal will come in 2030?

Manan Shah: So, see we have acquired the different mines at different points of time, but we entered Guinea in 2016, and our first mines acquisition was much later. So most of these mines would be having got the right of exploitation maybe before 2 or maximum 3 years. So you can add it up from there.

Bhavin Chheda: So do you mean only two, three mines are...

Manan Shah: No I'm saying -- so the yes the first renewal would be 12 years away and that is also an automatic renewal kind of a system. It's not like that it is like a reset process and that's what we have currently.

One thing I would like to add here for the benefit of all those on the call is that Guinea has seen large MNCs and you can find out about this yourself which are working there for at least period of 50 years.

So Guinea actually offers lot of stability to those who have invested into the country, into the mining assets. So many of the big MNCs have been operating there for several years way beyond 15, 20 or 30 years and they still continue to operate comfortably. So the idea is that the mining concessions are truly in spirit with us and we can use them for a very long period of time.

Bhavin Chheda: And the last question, the mining operation is done by the local contractor as well as the port management is done by the Chinese contractor or the contractor, or we have a team in place which is doing any of these two operations?

Manan Shah: So currently all the operations across mining and port are handled by the Ashapura team.

Bhavin Chheda: Okay. Thank you and best of luck.

Manan Shah: Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you. Next question comes from the line of Ronil Dalal from Ficom Family Office. Please go ahead.

Ronil Dalal: So my first question was that, what would be the Bauxite price presently and how would we be able to track it? You mentioned the China Bauxite price. So would that be the China, Guinea Bauxite index?

Chetan Shah: See the current Bauxite price is \$74.5 per ton dry metric ton basis C&F China. So that all depends upon there is an international index, there is one index is produced by from the Australian company and there is a three index is by the Chinese company or the. And normally they take the average of the three index and to make it

the kind of price calculations. So currently it is the \$74.5 C&F

China any major port in China.

Ronil Dalal: The next, want to just check -- you mentioned that the demand is much later than the supply. So what would be the reason that we're not able to supply the full 15 to 16 million tons as of today?

Manan Shah: So company is in a basically a position of ramping up, its infrastructure and in terms of the roads, the port and like this. It basically some of these assets have been ready earlier some of these have been ready more recently and so and also we basically there is a process of development also of a mine

where on the first day or on the first year you cannot expect that the full volumes would be available on the first year.

I think it's just a question of time that certain things take time to develop to a certain stage. So I think it's just a journey that we are making. What is important to note is that the capital investment and requisite, sort of agreements all are in place. And now we see that the momentum to continue.

Ronil Dalal: And the shipping lines are also available. I mean the ships, and all are available for supply because sometimes there shortage of ships?

Manan Shah: So the ships are easily available in a somebody and there is an index for this also for tracking the sea freight which is available. I currently don't have the exact name with me but for these specific routes there are indexes available and vessels are available.

Chetan Shah: Yes, normally we follow the C3, the shipping route. And that starts from the Brazil and it's to end into China. So we follow the same the C3 routes. And if you look at that C3 routes that today current

the shipping freight will be about \$24 per ton.

Manan Shah: So, the one -- the one thing I would like to advise is that these indexes give us a kind of trend in terms of whether prices are increasing or decreasing but their exact prices may have only some correlation to our prices it may not be literally that the index price may be exactly our price our price may be higher or lower depending on the exact customer exact location and the terms of delivery, but this

gives you an indication what is the mood of the particular index or market , when you check out

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whether it is the bauxite pricing index or the shipping indexes ; it will offer you a kind of mood in the or the trend in which things are moving.

Ronil Dalal: Where in one thing...

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt , sorry to interrupt Mr. Dalal, may we request to return to the question queue for follow -up questions ...

Ronil Dalal: Yes, sure.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Viral Nagda from Vivid Financial Services , please go ahead .

Viral Nagda: Thanks , thanks a lot for arranging this call was much needed for the investors and I would like to congratulate the management for building a strong business in Guinea . My first question comes about the company that we have that as you have guided that 15-million -ton export , we are expecting in FY '28. Now, I need to understand what is the roadmap for this and how are we going to overcome the issues of logistics or barges like barges availability or all those things so I just want a road map or a viewpoint how are we going to overcome those things ?

Manan Shah: I think we have iterated this in the earlier questions that we are expecting some sort of a linear progression from where we are today , to the target that we have put so that's the first question and regarding to logistics and barging I think as explained or as I would like to explain that now that we have a very good quality partnerships , with leading marine logistics players we expect that that should take care of the situation .

So, we have got three years contracts with them of course like I mentioned earlier that the contracts are solely based on vol

ume pricing remains dynamic but we have contracts with reputed players and this offers us some stability on our ability to execute volumes .

Viral Nagda: Understood. Sir, last one question just wants to understand a little bit on EBITDA per turn or margin 's part. As we saw in last two quarter like Q4 and Q1, margins volumes were quite good, but the margins were not that, I am talking about margin percentage EBITDA margin, that was not impressive as expected. What is EBITDA per t on or breakeven point in dollar term approximately ...?

Manan Shah: The current EBITDA is available to you through calculation from the numbers I at this point I can only comment that we expect to maintain or improve these numbers in time to come.

Viral Nagda: Okay can we expect margins to get better with the volumes going ahead in Q 3, Q4?

Manan Shah: We hope for the best .

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Viral Nagda: Okay thank you thank you thanks a lot and just one small thing if possible, please provide monthly export or volume numbers that would be much more helpful to us as investors , that's it Thank you , thank you sir .

Moderator: Thank you, our next question comes from the line of BR Nahar from Mili Emergin Equity Fund . Please go ahead .

BR Nahar: Thank you for giving the opportunity and heartiest congratulations on arranging this first maiden call. My question is about you are operating currently two mines and in your M arch presentation you have given that you have entered into contract with China Rail for developing another mine ; so, whether the volume of that mine which is going to be operated by China Rail is in addition to what you have projected 15 , 16 million tons by ' 27, '28 that is on bauxite side and on iron ore mine side whether what kind of a fee you have there currently and after beneficiation what kind of a fee you will get and whether you will be done exporting or what kind of arrangement you have currently ?

Manan Shah: So, okay I what I can understand two questions one is on the China Railway , what we expect is that they are basically partnering us in one of our mines location to improve the capacity that we are able to execute from this mine. So in the existing mines there's there working with them will help us to significantly improve the volumes that we can deliver from one of our mine s and regarding to your second question on iron ore , we have basically like a middle grade iron ore but this iron ore is easily benefit -- beneficiable so I mean it can be easily upgraded via standard washing and related processes so that's why we are working with a local beneficiation plant because once it is upgraded it may it is

more profitable to export , than to export low grade ore .

BR Nahar: But that iron ore, will you will be exporting or what is the arrangement basically ? If you can ...

Manan Shah: Our contract is local sales , so we would we would be working closer to a mine level and lesser at an export level .

Moderator: Thank you, ladies and gentlemen, due to paucity of time that will be the last question for today, for any further questions please reach out to Adfactors team . I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for closing comments .

Manan Shah: Thank you so much. We would like to thank you sincerely for your time and patience ; we look forward to your trust and support as we move forward in this exciting phase of our journey of value creation sustainability and leadership. We are committed to maintain consistent engagement with our stakeholders .

We have begun to provide more structured insights into our business divisions and operations . Going forward our disclosures will include quarterly volumes of bauxite from our G uinea business , along with division wise details . As a part of our enhanced investor engagement initiatives , we have recently circulated our first i

nvestor note , providing concise overview of our operations and business structure .

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We look forward to strengthening this dialogue further through our quarterly calls and other platforms of interaction .

Thank you once again and we look forward to our continued association . For any further details please reach out to Ad factors

Moderator: Thank you, everyone . Thank you on behalf of Ashapura Minechem Limited, that concludes the conference call . Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines .

Call: Nov 2025

Ref No.: Minechem/Stock Exch/Letter/ 8397 25th November, 2025

The Dy. General Manager,
BSE Limited
Corporate Relations & Services Dept.,
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street, Mumbai - 400 001 The Dy. General Manager,
National Stock Exchange of India Ltd.,
Corporate Relations Dept.,
Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block-G
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E),
Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Code: 527001 Scrip Code: ASHAPURMIN

Dear Sir/Madam,

Sub.: Disclosure under Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 – Transcript of Earnings Conference Call.

This is in continuation to our letters dated 18th, 19th and 21st November, 2025 in respect of the captioned subject .

Pursuant to Regulations 30 read with Para A of Part A of Schedule III and other applicable provisions of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, as amended, we attach herewith the transcript of “Ashapura Minechem Limited Q2 FY'26 Earnings Conference Call” held on 21st November, 2025. The transcript is also uploaded on the Company's website <https://www.ashapura.com/investors/share-holder-information/investor-call.html> .

Kindly take the above information on record.

Thanking you, Yours faithfully, For Ashapura Minechem Ltd.,

Sachin Polke
Company Secretary &
President (Corporate Affairs)

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“Ashapura Minechem Limited Q2 FY'26 Earnings
Conference Call ”

November 21, 2025

M
MANAGEMENT : MR. CHETAN SHAH - PROMOTER DIRECTOR ,
ASHAPURA MINECHEM LIMITED
MR. MANAN SHAH - PROMOTERS GROUP , ASHAPURA
MINECHEM LIMITED
MR. ASHISH DESAI - CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER ,
ASHAPURA MINECHEM LIMITED
MR. SACHIN POLKE - COMPANY SECRETARY ,

ASHAPURA MINECHEM LIMITED

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Ashapura Mine chem Limited Q2 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Adfactors.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing '*' and then '0' on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

This conference call may contain forward -looking statements about the Company which are based on the beliefs, opinions and expectations of the Company as on date of this call. These statements are not the guarantees of future performance and involve risks and uncertainties that are difficult to predict.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Chetan Shah – Promoter Director of Ashapura Minechem Limited. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Chetan Shah: Thank you. Good afternoon, friends. I would like to extend a very warm welcome to all of you on this 2nd Quarter 's earning calls and that's a half year ended on the September 30th, 2025. It

gives me immense pleasure to connect with you once again. This beginning 2nd Quarter 's earning call, we deeply appreciate your continuous interest, your support, your confidence in Ashapura Group's journey. On call with us, we have our CFO – Mr. Ashish Desai ; our Company Secretary, Sachin Polke and also Mr. Manan Shah who is the part of Promoters Group. And also we are very thankful to Adfactors who are our investor relationship team.

A quick recap, as you know that Ashapura has started in 1982. Many of you are joining first time on this call. So, I would like to say something that Ashapura has started its modest beginning in 1982 with the single product, Bentonite. Today, we are a multi -product, multi -solutions company and we are now going with a lot of the new initiatives for our group. We also diversified our activities in the various countries, especially in the Guinea and so Ashapura is divided in two parts, the business in India as well as the business outside the India. So, Indian business is basically is based on our own raw materials coming from our own mines but we are going for more on value -added products while the Guinea business is mainly based on the resource base and we are mining in a very large scale and exporting our products to various countries.

I give you a very brief idea about the Guinea business. In 2nd Quarter , which is normally is always affected with the monsoon season but however, in this quarter, we have done export of 1.33 million tons of bauxite which is almost double when compared to the previous corresponding quarter of last financial year. The main reason to have this thing is because of the Ashapura Minechem Limited
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better planning, we have made a very proper arrangements for the logistics and the ocean -going vessels as well as maintain the good quantity of the stocks in the port and also maintain the roads, which is normally these roads are most important part of our logistics arrangements. So, having all the factors in place, we are able to maintain a good volume of bauxite exports out of Guinea. You can say that the first half of this year was remain a more as consolidation and forward momentum for the Ashapura. For that, we have taken several initiatives and that each initiatives is taking us the steady progress across the Guinea as well as the business in India. Last year, our biggest challenge was the logistics, which was the marine logistics, the arrangements of barging as well as transshippers. At the same time, it is also the challenge to finding the vessel, ocean-going vessels at the right timings and at the right freight. To overcome this kind of issues, we have entered into a long-term arrangements.

Of course, this is driven by the index, but we have made the long -term arrangements for the coming quarters or you can say the calendar year 2026, so that we will not face any such problems related with the barging, transshippers or the ocean -going vessels. We have in contact with the company, who are a world -recognized company, providing such kind of logistic supports and we have made a long- term agreement with this company on basis of, again, on basis of index.

To overcome some of issues in Guinea, we have a large deposit was available, is available, but there was some kind of connectivity problems. So, during last two quarters, we were very busy building some kind of a special bridge over the river. It is the one of like a big initiatives from our side, so that we can access to a large and a good quality deposits in the other parts of our mining areas in the mines called BOFFA . This bridge work is already completed. We are going

to start, the opening of the bridge will happen on 27th of November, very precisely. The bridge is about 60 meters above the ground level and the length of the bridge is about 100 meters. Estimated investment, we do not have the exact figure as on today, but it would be in excess of about Rs. 80 crore. Having these arrangements in place, we will have access to a very good quality of bauxites and a very large quantity of bauxite, which will help our volume in forthcoming quarters. There are few other initiatives also in the same area related with developing the mines. We have put up the new equipment, new mining equipment and lot of other handling equipment, so that we can have the efficiency and can have the better loading rate on daily basis.

Indian, coming back to the Indian business :

In Indian business, you can say that if you compare with the first half of the current year and the first half of the previous year or the corresponding year, there is more than 25% growth in the business. This is also because of normally the monsoon quarter, the quarter which is starting from the July to September, which is always not very positive quarter for any mining business. But this year, we have taken a lot of new initiatives and made a very good planning in a way that

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so we can have a good result and will not suffer because of the monsoon season. And that is why you can see that there is about 25% growth in overall Indian business compared to previous corresponding the first half of financial year. So, Indian business is also growing very well, as well as the Guinea business is also growing very well. And we expect that we will, despite of the prolonged monsoon and despite of lot of destructions, we will be able to still able to achieve our target for the coming quarters without much problems. So, I feel that we are going in the right directions. And at the same time, of course, the few things, Manan will cover in his address to all of you, but in like there is a very stable price, the very stable demand and more or less the volume what is we plan to produce, which will be covered for the next year without much problems. So, we look that it is very exciting. The second half of this year will remain more exciting compared to the first half. And we are an entire Ashapura team is working towards this goal so that we can achieve our target as per given or we mentioned you in our earlier communications.

I appreciate your attending this call. And I will hand over this to our CFO, Ashish Desai to give you some figures, quick figures that will help you to understand more about our current performance. Thank you very much.

Ashish Desai: Thank you, Chetan sir. And good evening, everyone.

Coming to the financial performance:

I will be giving you numbers for Quarter 2 as well as H1 of '26. First of all about Quarter 2, consolidated revenue from operation for the current quarter that

at is Quarter 2 stood at Rs. 952.5

crore, reflecting growth of around 57% year on year. And this is basically primarily driven by continued strength in the Guinea bauxite exports and stable performance across domestic

verticals. EBITDA for the Quarter 2, '26 doubled year on year which was Rs. 132.1 crore and 102.6% growth that is 13.9% which was 10.8% in last quarter of '25. And this improvement also again was supported by improved cost efficiencies and higher operating leverage.

Talking about profit before tax:

PBT for Quarter 2 Financial Year '26 was Rs 81.2 crore, growing over 128% year on year with PBT margin at 8.5% which was 5.9% in Quarter 2 of '25. Basic EPS for Quarter 2, '26 stood at 10.11 compared to 4.71 in the same period of last year.

Talking about H1 number in totality, consolidated revenue for H1 stood at Rs. 2,308 crore, reflecting growth of around 75% year on year. Talking about EBITDA, H1, '26 came to Rs. 319.9 crore which is up 105% year on year with margin percentage of 13.9% compared to 11.8 in H1 of 25. Profit before tax, H1, '26 was Rs. 213 crore, growing at 112% year on year with

PBT margin of 9.2% which was 7.6% in the last first half. Basic EPS, H1, '26 stood at 21.61

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compared to 11.22 in the same period of last year. Despite an approximate 3% correction in bauxite prices and a stronger local currency, EBITDA per metric ton of Guinea bauxite has dropped very slightly. It was USD 8.9 per metric ton compared to USD 9.3 per metric ton in Quarter 1, supported largely by improved internal operational efficiency

One major point to be highlighted is about income tax. During the quarter, if we see consolidated public result profit and loss, Rs. 24.76 crore is added to PBT. As a net income tax impact on consolidated profit and loss. This is mainly because parent company order related to litigation in respect of carried forward losses aggregating amount Rs. 259 crore settled in favour of the

parent company. Company has recognized deferred tax assets and credited Rs . 34.62 crore to the profit and loss.

I will request Manan now to explain the dynamics of the Guinea and India business.

Manan Shah: Thank you, Ashish Bhai. Good evening , everyone.

Let me take you through some key business developments of Quarter 2 and H1 of FY '26:

We will begin with Guinea. In the first half of FY '26, we exported 3.38 million metric tons of bauxite. We have almost achieved the full year volume of FY '24-'25. The infrastructure we have built, including 3 ports and over 370 km of in-house and mines to port road network is now finally enabling easier execution of higher volumes. Our partnership with China Railway is progressing well. We have started working jointly in mining, logistics and port operations, which will give us a much stronger foundation to manage operations and improve our capability to execute. Our BO FFA and GSM port expansion remains on track to complete by Q2 FY '27. And this will lift our total handling capacity at these ports from 16 million metric tons to 27 million metric tons, allowing us to serve both captive and third-party cargo more efficiently. As mentioned earlier, bauxite prices have seen a little bit of correction, 5% approx. over the quarter. However, the demand for bauxite continues to be very stable.

Our production volumes are fully committed for calendar year FY '26. However, the pricing will be adjusted as per the index. We see aluminum metal prices as fairly strong and stable and we expect this to support bauxite prices going forward. I would like to highlight that there was some monsoon impact for the month of October. However, things are much better now and the Company is fully geared up to achieve its internal targets.

About our iron ore business in Guinea, we have mentioned earlier that we have a strategic long-term sale and purchase agreement

with a local beneficiation plant and we are happy to announce that trial production has begun. We are expected to commercialize further within the next two quarters. We would like to reiterate that we are confident of achieving our target of 15 million metric tons in FY '27-'28.

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Coming to our India business :

All four of our India verticals continue to deliver stable performance and improved realizations, despite Q2 being a seasonally weaker quarter. I will briefly cover each of our verticals ; Bentonite and Allied Minerals. This year, we were better prepared for the monsoon with investments in operations and sufficient pre-monsoon inventory storage. This helped us to maintain strong sales and dispatch momentum. Strong focus on iron ore pelletizing business and construction sectors supported us. We continue to focus on value-added applications in oil and gas, foundry and environmental solutions. We would like to share that we have started production in two new bentonite mines in Kutch after receiving all clearances recently. We expect to distribute 300,000 tons annually, which will improve the cost structure and the sales potential for this vertical.

Coming to our next division wide performance minerals :

We had a strong growth in our kaolin products led by increasing export demand for our current product portfolio, particularly in paint and fiberglass segment. Currently, we are close to complete capacity utilization at our Pad dhar Kaolin plant. We remain focused on new product development and customer acceptance efforts through our Ashapura Innovation and Knowledge Center, which will boost our brand revenues and margins over the medium term. We are looking at capacity expansion in the near future for our higher value product lines within the same facility.

Our third division, Specialty Absorbent Solutions:

Bleaching clay, a forward integration of our bentonite mineral, continues to operate at near full capacity utilization, backed by robust demand from edible oil refiners. We see a strong and increasing demand from the edible oil sector, where your company commands over 70% market share in the premium clay segment in India. Exports are also improving on a year-on-year basis, as India remains a cost-efficient destination for this product globally. We are now evaluating suitable options to further increase our bleaching clay capacity through de-bottlenecking and brownfield expansions. Company is currently undertaking a detailed evaluation for the same. The recent commissioning of our 9-megawatt solar plant, which is linked to this bleaching clay plant under the group captive model, has helped to lower cost and reinforce our sustainability goals. Please note, APL owns 26% of the solar SPV. We foresee a minimum 20% reduction of the power cost at this plant from this initiative.

Our fourth division, advanced ceramic materials :

Our associate company, Orient Ceratech Limited, witnessed a strong quarter with both Q2 and H1 profits more than doubling YOY. Market sentiment in the oil and gas segment has been particularly encouraging, which is a key driver for our propens business. Other ceramic

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businesses such as NRM, castables and refractory raw materials are also growing steadily. The China plus one opportunity continues to strengthen. For example, we have recently seen the imposition of anti-dumping duties on China in Europe for some of our ceramic products. We remain well positioned to cater to this shift. Overall, our India business is growing steadily, backed by captive raw materials, positive demand tailwinds and continuous focus on development and sales of value-added materials.

This is all from our side. We now open the floor for questions. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin with the question-and-answer

session. Our first

question comes from the line of Ronak Jain from Sanghvi Family Office. Please go ahead.

Ronak Jain: Good evening, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. Most of my answers are covered in opening remarks. I have just one question. What amount of PAT Ashapura estimates to spend on R&D?

Which segment for R&D? That's my question.

Manan Shah: You want to know the percentage of spend of R&D of revenue?

Ronak Jain: No, offset. Incoming future. What are we estimating R&D cost?

Manan Shah: Sure. So, I think that I would like to say that our R&D cost currently is quite a low percentage of PAT. I have not calculated exactly currently, but it is not very high in terms. But going

forward, maybe we can reach 2 %-3% of PAT, which we think is sufficient for the size of our Company and the kind of business we are in. I think 2 %-3% could be a medium-term goal. But currently, we may be a little bit lesser than that.

Ronak Jain: So, thank you. Just one more question. The bauxite rate which we are assuming, it will be stable at these prices going forward, right? Is my understanding correct?

Manan Shah: Correct. So, currently, bauxite prices, as we mentioned, have declined about 4 %-5% over the last 90 days or so. Broadly, our view is that bauxite is not a very volatile commodity and prices are generally stable when you compare it to iron ore or other such more volatile commodities.

Our in-house view is that prices should be at least stable over here or may even increase a little bit from here. This is our view as on date. But mostly, we expect it to remain stable at the very least.

Ronak Jain: So, just last question if I can squeeze in. So, what are the 2-3 factors which can affect bauxite rate both upside and downside?

Manan Shah: I think that as we can see that US-China relations are, for example, slowly improving, but slowly.

This kind of improvement could definitely contribute to the increase in bauxite prices and

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aluminum prices. So, I think just a little bit of the global uncertainty, if it were to be reduced, we would expect a positive effect on our product.

Ronak Jain: Sure. Thank you. Thank you for answering.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Parikshit Gujarati from Niveshaay. Please go ahead.

Parikshit Gujarati: Thank you for the opportunity, sir. So, I had just a question that can you provide a detailed breakdown of the cost structure? So, if suppose a bauxite is selling at the price of \$74 per ton, so what are the mining costs? What are the port and logistics costs? And what are the freight costs, etc.?

Manan Shah: Currently, on this call, I will not be able to provide a detailed costing. However, most of our costs are related to the logistics, both road and sea logistics and transshipment logistics. So, most of our costs are actually built from logistics and mining is a smaller part of the cost.

Parikshit Gujarati: Can we do in percentage terms?

Manan Shah: Currently, I would not be able to give you offhand on percentage terms. However, I mentioned that currently our EBITDA is close to \$9. So, and to some extent, of course, with the bauxite prices, the freight also has a certain correlation. So, we do expect that currently how we are operating, we do expect that we can maintain this kind of EBITDA in the future. So, that's one point what I can mention. But detailed breakup on this call may take quite a while because we have maybe more than 20 different cost headers.

Parikshit Gujarati: Okay. And so, my second question is that what is the correlation between bauxite prices and your EBITDA? So, if suppose the bauxite prices fall 10% from here, what would be the effect on EBITDA? Are you saying that you will be able to maintain 13 %-14% margins, which you are doing currently in the next 2-3 years?

Manan Shah: So, there

is some correlation between the bauxite prices and the freight, which we pay to ocean-going vessels to deliver our bauxite. So, a lower bauxite price may also be linked to, of course,

we cannot say this for certain, but a lower bauxite price can typically result or can have the, at the same time, the possibility of a lower freight price. They are not completely correlated, but there is a partial correlation. It would be very difficult to predict exactly what would happen if the 10% of the fall in bauxite prices were to happen. To some degree, our EBITDA may get compressed, but not by the full degree. So, if 10% of the bauxite prices fall, it's not like our margin would also reduce by 10%, but there would be some percentage impact. But I would not say the correlation is 100%. It would really depend on the cost of fuel, the cost of vessels at that

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point. But of course, if the prices were to drop 10%, it would have a negative impact on our margins.

Parikshit Gujarati: And sir my next question was that, that where are you seeing such massive growth in aluminum demand that you have planned such a big CAPEX of from 3 million metric tons to 15 million metric tons in the next three years? So, what are the demand drivers you are seeing from China and from across the world?

Manan Shah: It's a good question. So, currently, if I am not wrong, China imports close to 200 million tons of bauxite. What is actually happening in this industry is that there were many traditional locations like Indonesia, Australia, and even some small quantities from India, Malaysia. However, what is happening in this industry is that Guinea is increasingly emerging as the most preferred destination to source bauxite from. So, while the aluminum global industry may be growing at very few percentage points, what we are seeing is a shift from many locations traditionally to Guinea as a preferred bauxite destination. There are many Chinese players who are not fully integrated. Most of their production may not be fully integrated in terms of the fact that the smelter owners are linked to the bauxite mine. So, many of them would like a partner like us, a proven mine owner from which they would want to buy bauxite from over the longer term. So, the opportunity actually comes that we provide a very good source of Guinea and bauxite to many Chinese companies as a strategic supplier to them and as well as the fact that Guinea will be the world's predominant destination for bauxite even in the medium term to longer term. So, the shift is there that things are moving from other locations to Guinea. And overall, the imported bauxite will increase as domestic bauxite. See, China did have some amount of bauxite sales as a part of their total bauxite consumption. But that continues to increase year on year due to depletion of reserve or some environmental related issues. Their imports should at least be going up 10% year on year even because of this. So, 10% to 15% even their imports may increase year on year as they continue to shift. So, there are a lot of positive tailwinds for Guinea in particular whether it is the lower domestic availability of bauxite or the changes of location preference. So, this is why we are very confident that even our target of 15 million tons or even something beyond that has a pretty solid and stable market where the quantities would be taken.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Vivek Singh from IOCL. Please go ahead.

Vivek Singh: Sir, my question is what as per you people, what are the new uses of aluminum or bauxite in the international market in terms of electric vehicle or renewable energy?

Manan Shah: So, definitely, I think the adoption of electric vehicles does help because there is more aluminum used in electric vehicles and also many of these solar panels. In India, you can see there is a

huge

growth of solar for example. So, all the base panels of solar are made out of aluminum. Also, generally, aluminum is also a very consumption-driven product. So, typically, it has always seen

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a stable growth whether it is in the basic applications like cans or other industries. So, I mean, I don't have specifics. Generally, when we see reports, we do see at least a minimum of 3.5% and up to 5% growth on various reports. But definitely, what I can think of is that EV and solar would be pushing a degree of that growth. But mostly, when we are working, we are assuming about 4% to 5% is something that we are working with. Our focus also remains a little bit more on this changing trends of bauxite in terms of the destination, the quality and the import substitution sort of. So, aluminum, I can only offer a general comment as of now.

Vivek Singh: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Vardhman Sancheti from A VS Equity. Please go ahead.

Vardhman Sancheti: Congratulations to the management for delivering such a fantastic set of numbers despite some challenges, right? So, my first question is that you had expanded the capacity, old capacity which is scaled to 27 million metric tons. So, by which year we would be attaining the full utilization level?

Manan Shah: So, currently, as we have mentioned that we have set a target for us of 15 million metric tons in FY'27-'28. For now, what I can say is that this is not the final target. We do have plans to grow

beyond this. That's why we are so focused on having the correct partnerships as far as logistics and other operations are concerned because this gives us the strength to execute far beyond 15 million tons. I might not be in a position to comment when the 27 million ton capacity would be fully utilized. But we can say safely that we are developing the capability to go far beyond 15 million tons.

Vardhman Sancheti: Maybe, can we expect by FY '30?

Manan Shah: I mean, it's possible.

Vardhman Sancheti: Okay. And sir, my second question is that Guinea is contributing nearly more than 70% of the turnover. I just want to know that what the management is planning to mitigate the country specific risk going forward? Are we diversifying with other minerals with respect to different geography?

Manan Shah: So, that's a good question. Historically, we have seen that many multinationals, specifically in the field of bauxite, have been operating in Guinea for at least 40 years to 50 years, if not more.

So, firstly, our perception of Guinea is that it is fairly stable and benign for businesses in the mining industry. So, that's my starting point. The second point about diversification in terms of moving from Guinea into other minerals or other geographies, I think that as a company, we do have a watch on other countries and mineral opportunities which they present. However, it would

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be too soon to comment on some kind of a specific plan. However, I mean, what we can say is that we are actively tracking other countries in Africa for mineral opportunity. It has taken us several years. We set foot in Guinea in 2016 and almost 8-9 years later that we have this performance now. So, it's very important that we are fully focused on developing this project to its potential and being able to recover our investments also soon. And at the same time, we are on the lookout for new opportunities in the rest of Africa. When there will be something concrete with us, we will be happy to share with you.

Vardhman Sancheti: Okay, thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Nalin Shah from NVS Brokerage. Please go ahead.

Nalin Shah: First of all, I think hearty congratulations on the Q2 and H1 performance, which is really excellent. My que

stion is that, Manan, whatever the numbers which you have given that '27-'28, we are talking of 15 million tons. So, based on that, if you can just tell us just for our understanding purpose, that what would be the current year, full year target and next year target so that we understand from the current year, if it is 8 million tons, that you will go to 11 million tons and then 15 million tons, that is first. And second question is that you had also mentioned about the China Rail ways, this thing is going on. So, this 15 million tons, does it include China Rail contract? And that will add further or it will be a part of this only?

Manan Shah: Sir, thank you for that question. Let me answer the second part first. China Railway is supporting us in our operations, infrastructure and logistics. So, to that extent, we are working with them as a partner. They are not the end customer for this bauxite. So, our target of 15 million tons does not include them as a customer. Rather, they are a partner who are supporting us in our journey to achieve this target. Regarding the next year and how we see the progression towards 15 million tons. So, we have kept 15 million tons target for the year after next essentially. We are

kind of expecting a linear progression. So, I think FY '24-'25 was about 3 million tons and we are targeting about 15 million tons. But we do think that it will be a close to linear progression, you can add it up. The point is that Q2 and Q3 always provide little bit of challenges and Q1 and Q4 or rather Q4 and Q1 is the years where we other quarters where we really ramp. Our objective is every year in Q1 and Q4 to take the Company to newer heights. This is how we are organized.

Nalin Shah: Correct. Okay. Thank you very much.

Manan Shah: Thank you. Thank you, Nalin bhai.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Mahavir Jain from Astrum Advisors. Please go ahead.

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Mahavir Jain: Hi, congratulations on a very good set of numbers. I just wanted to know that as we are targeting a 15 million ton and also a further increase, what kind of EBITDA can we expect with the operational leverage kicking in?

Manan Shah: So, with the information which we have, I definitely believe that there may be still some room to improve the efficiency of our operations given that we are still quite far away from our target of 15 million tons. I think that every quarter, like we mentioned earlier, our CFO Ashish bhai mentioned that despite the almost 3% drop in bauxite prices, our EBITDA was quite stable and

did not reflect the equivalent drop. And a lot of that is because of improved operational efficiencies because we have the support of our partners, which contributes a long way to managing our cost. And we are also improving as time goes by. In my opinion, if prices are to remain stable, definitely we think that this would be the lower end of the EBITDA range. I would not be currently in a position to comment that how far the EBITDA can increase, but I can say that there is a scope to improve the margins, probably as the volumes increase, we should see that efficiencies will increase from here because our infrastructure and planning is for a far bigger volume. So, we do see that that should kick in.

Mahavir Jain: Yes, that is what. So, is there any remote chances? Are there any remote chances of the EBITDA reaching at \$20 per ton?

Manan Shah: I think that is too remote.

Mahavir Jain: Okay. All right. Thank you so much.

Manan Shah: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Su darshan Mal I from Dhunseri Investments. Please go ahead.

Sudarshan Mal I: First of all, congratulation for good set of numbers. As you mentioned in the call that there's a lot of shift changes happening in demand for bauxite from Guinea rather than other parts of the world.

It would be helpful if you could add some color, like why is this shift happening? Why are people preferring more of Guinea's bauxite versus RWA?

Chetan Shah: So, a few important things is that, like the current, earlier the Guinea has been coming into the big way into export of bauxite. So, Australia, Malaysia, and Indonesia were dominating for the specially the supplies to China. Now, the Australia has reduced the volume for many reasons, but currently they have reduced the volume of exports. So, Australia is now exporting only 30 million tons to China. Indonesia has completely banned the export of bauxite. And same way the Malaysia is doing very small volume, something like quota-based exports, which is not more than 3 million to 4 million tons per year. India was also one of the prominent exporters to China.

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But since the government of India has imposed the 15% duty on export of bauxite, and at the same time, the quality of Indian bauxite was not so high, so that India is also gradually dropped from the race. So, currently you can say the dependable source of the bauxite is only remain the Guinea. On the other hand, the Guinea is the largest bauxite reserves in the world, which is estimated about 30 billion tons of bauxite, which is a proven reserves, and it can go up to 50 billion tons probable reserves. So, second thing is the Guinea government, like that depends on the export of minerals, primarily bauxite, and in future, maybe iron ore. So, it is 40% of the GDP of the Guinea government. So, Guinea government is also supporting the export of bauxite. So, if you look at that this volume in Guinea, now currently is 150 million tons, which expected to be about 200 million tons in next two years or what you can say, 10% growth in the export of the bauxite because there is no other country, like Brazil, it's a very limited export. Ghana has also very limited export. So, if you any new capacities coming in China or in India, which has to depend on the imported bauxite, and that is the source is currently is only Guinea. So, looking at all these factors, the Guinea will remain very prominent exporter of bauxite for I think next few decades.

Sudarshan Mal I: That was helpful, sir. So, just one more question. We were reading that, the smaller mining companies were recently barred from mining activity in Guinea. So, just wanted to understand that, what was the backdrop? And like, how do we see the situation? Basically, I do want to understand the backdrop and have we received any kind of information or anything on that?

Chetan Shah: Actually, you can say that Guinea government has cancelled more than 180 mining licenses. Primarily, it is related with the gold and rare earth and few different minerals, and not too many from the bauxite mining. So, because people have obtained the licenses, have not been doing any activities for a very, very long time. They're not making any new investment. And the idea is to get the license and sell it with the premium to other producers or you can say other companies. In such case, Guinea government say that if you are not actively using your permit, then it is no need of to continue it, because the permit is issued for you to produce the minerals, invest in the country and not for just the trading purpose. You know, it's just you buy, get the permit because of some reason, and then you sell it that permit. So, they have cancelled this kind of permits or you can say licenses. Those who are doing the genuine business of this thing, they are not affected by this cancellation policy. Only mainly is the gold licenses, which has been cancelled. Primarily, you can say 90% is the old gold related or rare earth related licenses. Rest all is been intact.

Sudarshan Mal I: Okay. So, if I may squeeze in just one last question.

Chetan Shah: Yes, go ahead.

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Sudarshan Mal I: Sir, given that we have such an optimistic outlook on volumes, and we have been delivering in the last two quarters also, but it seems that you are not refraining from giving any guidance of increasing EBITDA per ton, which is an obvious outcome that will happen. Just want to understand, if there is any risk that you are kind of seeing, which we should be aware of, or like why this, if I may ask, which looks very inevitable that margins will expand with such massive volume growth?

Manan Shah: Sorry, can you just rephrase that?

Sudarshan Mal I: Basically, I am trying to understand that when the output from the volume is so bright, but still, management is kind of re fraining from giving any expansion in EBITDA margins or EBITDA per ton guidance. So, is there any kind of risk that you guys are, like, trying to first see that and then, so, are there any risks to the very optimistic story, which we should be aware of?

Chetan Shah: So, it's not really from the point of view of that, can we see some risks, and so we are refraining from giving the guidance. I think that, as the starting point for these discussions was a very clear committed target of 15 million tons. We do, however, refrain from giving quarterly guidance or guidance on EBITDA, even though we have mentioned that we think this is the lower end of the range at these prices and we expect operations to stabilize. See, mining industry has, of course, its own chal lenges and commodities and cycles. What our real focus area is that we want to build our infrastructure, our partnerships and our customers so that we can easily discharge a 15 million tons of volume and this is how we are focused. Sometimes it can happen that in a quarter, couple of vessels, each vessel is having 200,000 tons. If two vessels leave after 2 days or 3 days, so the quarterly numbers can often change, subsequently things can change. So, and you know, each vessel is worth maybe \$ 10 million -\$15 m illion, if not more. So, even sometimes you have the cut -off date of 31

st and something and then the vessel goes few days later. So, there can be some kind of volatility on a quarterly basis and we really want to focus on the long-term goals of the Company, in which case we have given a clear long -term guidance both on the volume which we want to achieve and that we want to definitely improve our EBITDA from here. So, that's what I can leave you with. It's not really about risk but just that we want t o maintain the long-term focus.

Sudarshan Mal I: Sure, sir. That was very helpful. Best of luck.

Chetan Shah: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Raj Shah from RK Family Office. Please go ahead.

Raj Shah: So, in the last call, you said that iron ore will not add meaningful in terms of revenue. But, sir, if I do some rough calculation, even if it is unbenefited and supplied to local area, then also with

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the mining capacity of 300 million tons, starting with 5 million and then to 10 million tons can have a meaningful impact on the topline. And sorry, if this question is repeated, I have just joined the call. And I also wanted to know what's the update on iron ore mining and what are the volumes you are seeing in coming years?

Manan Shah: So, we had mentioned in our introductory presentation that our iron ore activities have begun. We are underway. Trial production has begun and we are supplying some quantities to the plant which we have mentioned earlier in our note. We are seeing that this should commercialize to meaningful volumes within a quarter or two. And the same has been communicated in the introductory presentation. Like you said correctly, the topline may not be very significant because the deal is on ex mines basis. However, it will contribute meaningfully to the bottomline

over a short period of time.

Raj Shah: No, sir. What I was ask ing is even if it is unbenefic iated and supplied to local area, then also I think on 5 million tons of supply or even next year 10 million tons of supply, it can have a very meaningful impact on topline. So, why you are saying that it will not impact topline?

Manan Shah: I will explain to you why. See, when we do a most of the bauxite transactions we are doing are on CIF basis, which means the revenue is on a delivered to China basis and logistics is a large part of the total revenue. When we are doing iron ore business, it is o n ex mines business. Earlier

on this call, I have also mentioned that the major part of the total cost comes from logistics and a very limited part of the cost comes from mining. So, any transactions which are undertaken on an ex mines basis would have far lower value than the delivered prices. So, when you see these iron ore indexes also they are delivered to China or something like this. The kind of business we are doing in iron ore is a very close to ex mine business. So, it won't be like the same pricing or even a fraction of the pricing. Let's say what would be if we were doing a let's say iron ore

transaction CIF to China. So, that's why the topline would be limited in the sense that because these are ex mines transactions. However, it should contribute meaningfully to the bottom line or some extent to the bottomline. The exact volumes that we can do once we have some more data from this trial production and all this, we should be able to share that once we are ourselves concluded with the potential of these mines. So, that's the explanation.

Raj Shah: Okay. So, sir, can you tell me like what per ton are we expecting from our iron ore selling?

Manan Shah: Like I mentioned that we are in trial production. We need some time ourselves to be able to ascertain the long-term realization from these resources on a per ton basis. But maybe at best, I can say that our realizations would be within a few dollars.

Raj Shah: Not \$40-\$45, like less than \$ 10 you are saying?

Manan Shah: It would definitely be less than \$10 dollars. Like I mentioned, it is an ex mines transaction.

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Raj Shah: I agree. I just wanted to. Okay. Thank you. This is my question.

Manan Shah: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We will take the last question from the line of Tushar Sarda from Athena Investments. Please go ahead.

Tushar Sarda: Thank you for the opportunity. I have a couple of questions. One of course has been answered.

You said that you are selling on CIF basis. So, on the realization from the volumes that you're given, it looks like it's around \$60-\$65 per ton. So, this is net of any royalty or taxes that you may have to pay on mining?

Manan Shah: The EBITDA data which we have given is after deducting all costs, including taxes and royalties. I mean, the final EBITDA.

Tushar Sarda: I am asking about realization. So, realization is gross of taxes or net of taxes ?

Manan Shah: The EBITDA per ton, basically EBITDA means earnings before interest depreciation.

Tushar Sarda: No, I am asking for revenue.

Manan Shah: Sorry. Can you rephrase exactly what you would like to know about the revenue?

Tushar Sarda: So, your revenue is Rs. 720 crores and the volume you have given is 1.33 million tons. So, that comes to around Rs. 5,500 a ton or maybe around \$60-\$65 a ton. So, this \$60-\$65 a ton is after taxes or before taxes that you may have to pay to the government.

Manan Shah: Sir, it's a gross revenue. It's before. However, I would not read it as, I would just like to caution against reading it as a realization of \$ 65. We do have some FOB contracts, which would, therefore, the FOB contracts would be without the freight. So, there would be like some contracts which would be at a much lower than \$ 75, maybe around close to

\$50 or something. So, on the

revenue side, there can be in a year, in a quarter, if you're doing more FOB business and less CIF business, the realization may appear to be down. But it's more to do with the fact that certain companies prefer to buy on FOB basis and book their own vessel. Certain companies prefer that we book the vessel and give them the product. So, the revenue can fluctuate. However, the focus is that the EBITDA per ton should be maintained in either model.

Tushar Sarda: Okay.

Manan Shah: And \$75 is also the price on a DMT basis. So, obviously, bauxite is not supplied with zero moisture. So, when we do supply the bauxite, it has some moisture, which is to be deducted pro

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rata. So, let's say there is a 10 % moisture in the bauxite, which we supply, we have to deduct the \$7.5. So, a combination of the fact that the index prices are DMT and that some of our contracts are on FOB basis is why the revenue number should not be misunderstood for a per ton realization. And that's why the company is focusing on EBITDA.

Tushar Sarda: Okay. I understood that. Second question was, you said that you use the ports and you build internal railway lines and also what is the average distance that you travel internally within Guinea before you reach the port?

Manan Shah: So, railway, hopefully someday. Today, we are having roads in Guinea. We have the, currently the two active mines, BOFFA and HUDA. And one is about, I think, approximately 120

kilometers is around in HUDA and around 60 kilometers is BOFFA. And so, this is the final distance, which has to be traveled from the mine site to the port. Within the mines, it's difficult to say, like, there would be different pits and different locations.

Tushar Sarda: Yes, that I understand. And what is the capacity of these ports? You have multiple ports, right?

So, what is the capacity?

Manan Shah: We have three ports, one supporting to iron ore and two supporting to bauxite. The total capacity is 16 million tons. We have offered the breakup also in our investor note shared in previous quarter, wherein our GSM port can do 6 million tons, BOFFA port can currently do 5 million

tons and our Konta port can also do 5 million tons.

Tushar Sarda: Okay. And iron ore will start from which quarter, Q3 or Q4?

Manan Shah: So, we expect, so like I mentioned, trial production has started. We are trying our best so that the commercial quantities can happen in this quarter. But max within two quarters, we should see some commercial quantities like at least like numbers, which would be at least close to like, say, a million tons or more within the next quarter or two. So, commercialization, I mean, we define by that at least 1 million tons a quarter or half million or something like this. So, just within a quarter or two quarters, we should be able to get that, subject we are just seeing how our trial run is going.

Tushar Sarda: And any guidance on EBITDA for iron ore on a per ton basis?

Manan Shah: Give us some time. Like I mentioned, we are in trial. We will be more than happy to bring that out into our information once we have a basic level of clarity. So, we will get to that.

Tushar Sarda: That's it. Thank you so much. Thank you and all the best.

Manan Shah: Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, due to paucity of time, we close the call. For further queries can be taken up with the investor relations team. I now hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Manan Shah: In closing, we would like to thank you all, our investors, analysts, and stakeholders for your continued support and confidence in our Company. The journey we have taken from India to Guinea, from raw materials to value-added solution, is one of transformation and resilience. As we

move forward, we are confident of sustaining our growth trajectory with strong fundamentals, focused strategy, and global partnerships. For any further information or clarifications, please feel free to reach out to our investor relations team at Adfactor s. Thank you so much. We appreciate the time and patience all of you have shown on this call. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Ashapura Minechem Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Feb 2026

Ref No.: Minechem/Stock Exch/Letter/ 8414 16th February, 2026

The Dy. General Manager,
BSE Limited
Corporate Relations & Services Dept.,
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
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National Stock Exchange of India Ltd.,
Corporate Relations Dept.,
Exchange Plaza, C- 1, Block -G
Bandra -Kurla Complex, Bandra (E),
Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Code: 527001 Scrip Code: ASHAPURMIN

Dear Sir/Madam,

Sub.: Disclosure under Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 – Transcript of Earnings Conference Call .

This is in continuation to our letter s dated 6
th and 11st February , 2026 in respect of the captioned
subject .

Pursuant to Regulations 30 read with Para A of Part A of Schedule III and other applicable provisions of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, as amended, we attach herewith the transcript of "Ashapura Minechem Limited Q3 FY'26 Earnings Conference Call " held on 11st February, 2026 .

The transcript is also uploaded o n the Company's website [https://www.ashapura.com/investor - call.php](https://www.ashapura.com/investor-call.php)

Kindly take the above information on record.

Thanking you, Yours faithfully,
For Ashapura Minechem Ltd.,
Sachin Polke
Company Secretary &
President (Corporate Affairs)

"Ashapura Minechem Limited
Q3 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call"
February 11, 2026

M
ANAGEMENT : MR. CHETAN SHAH – PROMOTER DIRECTOR – ASHAPURA
GROUP
MR. MANAN SHAH – PROMOTER GROUP – ASHAPURA
MINECHEM LIMITED
MR. ASHISH DESAI – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
ASHAPURA MINECHEM LIMITED
MR. SACHIN POLKE – PRESIDENT , CORPORATE AFFAIRS
– ASHAPURA MINECHEM LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to Ashapura Minechem Limited Q3 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Adfactors. This conference call may contain forward -looking statements about the company, which are based on the beliefs, opinions, and expectations of the company as on the date of this call. These statements are not the guarantee of future performance and involve risks and uncertainties that are difficult to predict.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode, and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this call is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Chetan Shah, Promoter Director of Ashapura Minechem Limited. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Chetan Shah: Thank you. Hello friends. Good evening. This is our third investors' call and I like to welcome all our stakeholders on this investors' call to review our quarterly performance. I also like to appreciate our team, including Manan, Ashish and Sachin, who have maintained this momentum to ensure that you receive all information on regular basis.

I agree that our quarterly results are par with our previous quarter, but certainly it is slightly below the expectations. The prolonged monsoon in Guinea had impacted our operations and affecting our overall performance. We are not achieved our expected volume, which we have planned for quarter three. It's not that there is -- we had sufficient commitment, but because of the climatic changes and some logistic difficulties because of changes in the climates, we could not push that volume.

It's not any other reasons, there is no lack of business or there is no lack of orders or not lack of any shipping arrangements, etcetera. But we could not reach to the expected volume, and that's affected the performance. At the same time, our team is working diligently to mitigate such effects and get back to things on track. I am sure the outcome should reflect in our forthcoming quarters.

I can tell more about the Guinea operations, but before that, just tell you that about the India also -- the Indian operations also have seen some headwinds mainly due to volatility in the raw material cost and the climatic changes.

At the same time, you could see that's remarkable improvement in our EBITDA margin, and this is mainly because of during the quarter, we are not paid any kind of a substantial demurrage, the maintain consistent shipping freight, and also our new tie -up with the mining and logistic contractors with the China Railway. This factor helped to improve the EBITDA margin.

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Besides that, we have taken several new initiatives, will help to maintain the consistent cost structure. This means the improvement in volume in future -- I mean that the improvement in the volume in the future and stabilize the market price will create a many more new records in coming quarters. We are quite optimistic for the future.

I know the current market price of the bauxite might be concern for all. It is our concern too. But the price in the last few days is stabilized at this level. And I think now it's the time to -- there will be a some revival in the price and that has to go towards north. We are waiting for the Chinese Spring Festival time, Chinese New Year time, and after that we could see that there will be some upward trend in the bauxite price. But at the current price also, we are fairly comfortable to continue our export activities.

The main reasons for the drop in the bauxite price are mainly because of some of the suspended leases in Guinea has started their operation. There is -- another fac

tor is the US -China long-term trade

deal is yet to be concluded. So that is all the trade deal is on the short -term basis. They're waiting for some trade deal to happen on long -term basis, which will again push the requirement and the demand for the aluminum metal.

Another factor is the China government has stopped the approval for the new smelters in China. They want the Chinese entrepreneurs to look anywhere in the world to set up the new smelters, it's related with aluminum or copper, and the -- not within the China. So Chinese entrepreneurs are looking for some new opportunities. And this is the reason, the new upcoming alumina refineries have the excess supplies of the alumina, and that has also given some pressure on the bauxite price.

If you look at that , how the bauxite price will go into the future and what are the reasons to be ? If you look overall the picture, the Guinea is the only country who has as a viable or commercially viable country to supply bauxite to the rest of the world. The Guinea will cross 200 million ton exports in this year. And currently, you won't see any other country in the world who can replace Guinea now or in next 10 years.

So Guinea will remain in a pre -- you can say in a very strong positions for coming many years.

There's no excess supplies is coming from any other part other than the Australia, that they -- they supplies about 40 million tons of bauxites, and there's no other countries like India or Brazil or Indonesia supplying any major exports either to China or any other countries in the world. So looking

to these factors, Guinea will remain in a very predominant conditions to continue to supply of bauxites.

And during the course of time we've taken several new initiatives, that's long- term tie -up with the mining and logistics company, long -term tie -up with the ocean freight. That will be a long-term sustainability for Ashapura for as far as the costing or you can say the cost structure is concerned.

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We are able to keep all our cost in control. Volume growth is very certain, and we have lot of optimism on the price stabilizations and reasonable level will put Ashapura in much better league. As you also know that Ashapura has hold the license for iron ore mining. Currently, our iron ore has been like we are supplying to the local beneficiation plant, and now our quality is fairly established and stabilized with the beneficiation plant. And we expect some substantial volume during this year. Of course, this is a local supply basis and we will continue to supply to this beneficiation plant whose requirement is very, very large. So we will have the some more additions of the business in Guinea besides bauxite.

So overall pictures looks quite interesting and we see that the whatever we could not able to achieve during the last quarters, we will be able to make up in coming quarters without any much problem. I really appreciate all your interest in our current activities, and we will continue to brief you on time to time. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Sir, should we open the floor for questions now?

Manan Shah: I think we will have a small address by our CFO and then some closing remarks and then we can do that. So over to you, Ashish bhai.

Ashish Desai: Thank you, Manan. And good afternoon, everyone. Coming to financial performance for quarter three and nine months for '25-'26. So first of all, let's see quarter three numbers. So consolidated revenue from operations for quarter three stood at INR 960.4 crore s, which is more or less par, to be precise, 0.8% quarter -on-quarter growth on the back of consistent growth in Guinea compared to quarter one.

EBITDA for quarter three stood at INR 143 crore s, which is a growth of 8.3% quarter -on-quarter. Margin is 14.9%, which was 13.9% in quarter two. This was mainly driven by reduced demurrage charges, enhanced

cost efficiency and like that. PBT and before exceptional item for quarter three stood at INR 89.31 crore s, growing over 10% compared to quarter -on-quarter, and margin was 9.3%, which was 8.5 % in quarter two. Basic EPS stood at 8.82 % for the quarter. Guinea contributed around 76% to revenue in quarter three, and India contributed 24.2%.

Coming to nine months of '26, consolidated revenue stood at around INR 3,268 crore s, reflecting growth of almost 50% year -on-year. EBITDA came to around INR 463 crore s, which is 52% up compared to year -on-year, with EBITDA margin of 14.2%, which was less than 14% in last nine months of the same year.

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Profit before tax and exceptional item for nine months was INR 303 crore s, growing 37% year -on-year. And PBT margin at 9.3% versus 10% for last nine months of '25. And basic EPS for nine months stood at 30.43.

One exceptional note which we have given in the published result also was one -time impact on our P&L because of labor code impact. Effective November '25, new labor code revised the definition of wages for the purpose of computing employee benefits. Following detailed assessment, company has recognized an incremental impact of INR 1.77 crore s at standalone level and INR 4.56 crore s in the consolidated result as an exceptional item.

So that's all from the number point of view. I would request Manan to explain the dynamics of the company.

Manan Shah: Yes. Just to share, thanks Ashish bhai. Just to share some of the closing remarks on our, long-term plan. We would like to reiterate that we are very confident of achieving our long-term volume target of 15 million tons. This is for the '27- '28 as we -- as we have stated. We are confident of that.

While currently the bauxite prices are lower than our expectation, we expect them to stabilize and gradually pick up. And we also see that our company has put a lot of efforts to optimize the cost, so we remain comfortable to make the shipments even at current prices. So we expect that while there is a -- while there is an impact of price, we expect that the increase in volume to more than offset that impact.

And regarding to the India business, we remain confident of our long-term vision and goal to improving profitability and sales through the addition of value-added products. And company remains focused on this goal in each of its major segments.

Thank you all for being with us on this call, and now we can open the floor for questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question and answer session. Our first question comes from the line of Kamlesh Bagmar from Lotus Asset Managers. Please go ahead.

Kamlesh Bagmar: Yes. Thanks for the opportunity. Manan bhai, just one question on the part of Guinea operation. So what is the cost of like say production or the cost till the delivery of bauxite?

Manan Shah: Okay. I think that we have commented on this cost structure on earlier calls also, but I think broadly the cost is a break-up into the three major categories you can consider, that we have the seafaring cost, we have the transshipment cost and then we have the mining and the logistics to the port cost. So broadly, these are the major costs which we are having.
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As we have mentioned that our previous quarter EBITDA has come in around \$10.5. So we expect that broadly some of these costs may be slightly elastic with the selling price, but most of the cost will remain relatively fixed or it will gain the efficiency over time. So while giving current complete break-up on the cost may not be possible, but we still expect that -- that our costing to be below the current -- even the current prices of the bauxite. So for now what we can mention is that we -- our costing would be below even the current price of bauxite

. However, detailed break-up would take time. The major components like I mentioned are sea freight, mining and logistics, and the transshipment costs. So that's what I can offer for now.

Kamlesh Bagmar: So let us say it is \$ 10.5 EBITDA per ton in this quarter. So what was the realization?

Manan Shah: I think at current bauxite prices probably the realization would moderate quite a bit.

Kamlesh Bagmar: No, I'm talking about Q3. How much was the realization, Q3?

Manan Shah: Realization is \$10.5, that's the EBITDA. Do you want the total number that is -- our volume declared volume is 1.39 and EBITDA is \$10. So about -- about \$14.5 million.

Kamlesh Bagmar: I am asking that what is the revenue there?

Manan Shah: Revenue, I heard realization, sorry. Revenue, I think -- so we have given the in the segment-wise break-up, we have given that the total turnover from our Guinea business has come INR 729 crore s.

Per ton the approx price would be around \$ 70. I mean, I'm converting the FOB also into the tentative CIF cost, but our average index -- so yes, that would be around \$70.

Kamlesh Bagmar: \$70 is FOB?

Manan Shah: CIF China. The equivalent would be \$70.

Kamlesh Bagmar: And any update on the iron ore business there I like say, what is this status?

Manan Shah: So iron ore business, as we mentioned last time, we were having some trial activity with this beneficiation plant, which has progressed quite well. It's still we feel too soon to say, but we are very hopeful that we would be having a very clear projection for iron ore at the end of the quarter 4, that what can be the kind of volume and the kind of realization which we -- which we can expect. I think we should be in a good position to comment on that at the end of quarter 4. But I think the general idea is that we think that our trials are going quite well with the partner on the beneficiation plant and we are -- we are at least confident that there will be a long-term iron ore business with them.

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Kamlesh Bagmar: Okay. And you have highlighted about the FY28 volume guidance on bauxite. So what -- what we are targeting for this year, FY27?

Manan Shah: I think that somewhere we have not given out a target basically, but we do think that it could be a linear growth as I have mentioned many times, that okay, we did in the previous year about 3 or 3.5 million tons and 15 million tons. So we expect like a linear ramp-up over the year-on-year and in that way. So from 3 million to 15 million with the -- with the three milestones in the middle, so you can add it up how it comes by, but we are expecting a linear growth between 3 last year and 15 as a target for 27-28.

Kamlesh Bagmar: Okay. Great. Thanks for that.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Naitik Mohata from Sequent Investments. Please go ahead.

Naitik Mohata: Hi. Good evening, sir and thank you for the opportunity. Sir, my first question is I think so we have discussed about this demurrage charges in our press release as well as in our opening remarks. So can you help us quantify what were these demurrage charges that were paid in quarter 2 like the amount for it?

Manan Shah: So I think that we're not currently offering that kind of data, but I can tell you that one of the reason we were able to increase our EBITDA even compared to quarter 2. Quarter 3 has a slightly lower pricing, still we were able to improve our EBITDA. So definitely the -- I can say a good part of that contribution -- I would even say maybe at about 20%, 25%, 30% of the improvement actually comes from the fact that our turnaround times for the shipments were much faster than quarter 2.

So there is a significant improvement and there may be still scope for a little bit more improvement as far as the demurrage is concerned as our execution capabilities are improving

. But I would say

that it is a -- a good part of the improvement in the EBITDA has come from our ability to turn around these vessels faster.

Naitik Mohata: Fair, sir. But sir, at the same time, I believe that quarter 3 volumes were not as per up to the mark as what we were expecting or what the management was expecting as well. So would that warrant another quarter of demurrage charges that might come—become a problem in coming quarters?

Manan Shah: Okay. So I think that the reason really was the prolonged monsoon and we have done our shipment planning accordingly. So despite having the little bit of the numbers -- our own internal targets we can safely say were missed for quarter 3, but despite that we had an improvement in demurrage. So our planning on the vessels was probably far better.

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I think quarter 4 also should see this kind of a turnaround or better. So because quarter 4 would have obviously no monsoon impact. I think our overall cost structure now is quite consistent and fairly fixed as we are stabilizing into -- into this journey. So demurrage being one of those costs has also improved.

Ashish Desai : Our future -- our future freight contracts at the load port, we have now working on CQD terms. So in CQD terms, there is no demurrage is applicable. So this is a new developments like the shipping company's agreed on the CQD terms. That means that the all the loading is without any demurrage. And this is a good benefit for the company and we can avoid and they can plan the shipment in a such a way that they—they don't have the loss and we also don't have the loss. And there's a very big international cap size career.

Naitik Mohata: That's very positive to hear, sir. Sir, secondly, on the pricing environment regarding bauxite, so there has been lot of headwinds regarding the pricing from bauxite, be it increased inventories at the alumina refineries in China or increase production out of Guinea. So at these prices, we are expecting that the prices to stabilize, but at current prices how sustainable would our EBITDA per ton of \$9-\$10 would be?

Manan Shah: So we definitely expect, as I tried mentioning earlier. We do expect that EBITDA will moderate as you can understand that our previous quarter we mentioned average pricing was around 70 and current pricing going around is 60 or 61 or something like this. So there would be an impact, but we still expect to be first of all, we are definitely confident of being EBITDA positive. That's the first point.

I think that there can be a moderation, at least maybe there would be a 40%, 50% moderation, which -- which I expect that may come in the EBITDA, but we expect that the volumes to offset the per ton kind of the reduced EBITDA. We expect the volume growth to support us in this phase which— which we are expecting from now on, but yes, we do think that there may be a 40%, 50% moderation in EBITDA.

Naitik Mohata: Okay. Fair, sir. Fair. Thank you. Thank you for the opportunity.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Dhananjai Bagrodia from Alchemy. Please go ahead.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Hi. Maybe you have missed this. Just a couple of things. A, broadly what capex numbers are we thinking for the next few years and B what is our cost of production versus some of our peers in terms of the cost curve?

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Manan Shah: Okay. I think capex basically might be the -- the way that we look at it is that basically in Guinea we feel that most of our capex is completed. We have a -- we as -- we are expecting that maybe compared to the capex we have done, another 20%, 25% more capex may come through over the next year or year and a half or so.

But we -- what we think we can highlight is that the bulk of the capex is done and also having a good partners with u

s has reduced the capex, burden on us to some degree. So that's the comment what I can offer on the future capex as far as Guinea is concerned. I think India will also see some capex which we are finalizing.

We are looking at expanding a couple of our business capacities, but that may be a little bit less significant in number than even the Guinea business. But we do feel that in Guinea most of our capex is on the way and that's why we are focused on ramping up volumes. Your second question was on the cost curve, that where are we? I would like to think that probably we are somewhere -- we have between the two deposits probably we would be somewhere in the middle of the curve. I think that there are -- there are short mines over there.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: So what would your number be, cost structure? What would your cost be?

Manan Shah: So I mean, currently like we mentioned that the price was about \$70 and our EBITDA was \$10, so about \$60 would have been our total cost CIF basis. In that maybe almost the \$25 would be the kind of ocean freight. So balance is our cost in which the major cost really is the logistics. The mining cost is never much, it's like \$2 or \$3 kind of a mining cost. So and then there are also more about -- about \$5 of government duties, taxes, royalty on the bauxite which we export per ton basis, etcetera. Going forward, we expect that so last quarter our costing would have been around 60, but going forward, we think that okay there may be some reduction in our operating costs or other efficiencies which we expect because like we said we did only the 1.3 million in the last quarter. Assuming that we are able to ramp up the volumes what we are looking at, some level of cost should drop further. What it may come in the next quarter that we will have to see, but we are confident of having costing below \$60 definitely for the next quarter. As far as the cost curve is concerned, I think that there are many—there are mine owners there, but they are operating since many years. So we have also got a advantage on the quality of our bauxite having the new mines and even one of our mines has a really high quality bauxite.

So when the pricing typically may drop like this, so our higher quality resources and reserves would help us to offset some of that pricing impact also. So that is an advantage we have being a new player in Guinea, that we have the quite a high quality resources also with us in one of our locations. So I

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mean in all our locations, but currently we are focusing on one of them that okay, that some of the shipment we can improve the quality and manage to even get a premium.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Fair. And in terms of exports from Guinea, where do you all usually sell to just in terms of?

Manan Shah: It's almost all to China.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Okay. All 100% to China. Okay. Fine. That is understood. And capex you said you already done with. Okay. Fantastic. And , okay , done. Thank you so much.

Manan Shah: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Surendra Kumar Khemka from Khemka Office. Please go ahead.

Surendra Kumar Khemka : Hello, sir. Any disturbance in mining in Africa? I have reading a report that some disturbance going on in Ghana. So any effect in Guinea also?

Manan Shah: Well, we actually mentioned that the some suspended mines has reopened. So I think that at least on the ground of it conditions are good for the mining activity. Currently we don't see any kind of disturbances at any major level.

Surendra Kumar Khemka : No, no. You are talking about opening of the mining. But I am saying that some mines are closed in—closing in Ghana for the disturbance, some how -so...

Manan Shah: No, currently in Guinea there is no such activity or that kind of response from the government. The one note we'd like to add that current

ly it's our feeling or our view that the current government is quite stable and quite proactive also. So we think that at least the business environment is quite good.

Surendra Kumar Khemka : Special activity. Okay. And in the last—in the last two, three months, the price of the aluminum has gone up. But why the price of bauxite is going down, due to the oversupply?

Manan Shah: So, as we mentioned that the—the point is the price of aluminum has gone up in part because there is a some restriction on the new capacities of smelters in China being one of the reasons. And a couple of other reasons also highlighted by my dad on the -- on the call, which also includes that we mentioned that couple of mines has opened up in Guinea which were suspended earlier. So, it's a mix of factors. However, yes , we are optimistic about price stabilizing and maybe gradually pulling upwards after maybe the Chinese New Year.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Kriti Tripathi from NVS Brokerage. Please go ahead.

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Manan Shah: I think we can get back to her.

Moderator: Sure. Our next question is from the line of Daisy Barocha from Sanghvi Family Office. Please go ahead.

Daisy Barocha: So, my first question is, China has imposed 45 metric ton aluminum smelting capacity cap. So—so this policy on incremental aluminum production and consequent on China's bauxite consumption. So do you see this acting as a structural headwind to bauxite prices over medium term?

Manan Shah: So definitely there is a new normal for the time being. We see couple of things which also mentioned earlier, that we see that many of these Chinese companies are looking at investing overseas for the smelter capacity. So globally smelters may come up maybe, in Middle East for example or some of

the other locations there may be a growth.

But we do think that the aluminum consumption we expect that okay, there may be a continuous growth in the consumption of aluminum and therefore the smelter capacities will continue to grow, but maybe the idea is that they may not grow in the for the time being in China. But we do think that outside of China, we think that new capacities may come up. This is our view, but maybe particularly we think in Middle East you may hear or see something soon.

As far as the pricing is concerned, yes, for now this is a kind of new normal, but we have to see that after the Chinese New Year we are optimistic that there can be some improvements. At the same time, like our —we are working on our cost structure to be able to be reasonably profitable at this level also.

Daisy Barocha: Okay. Thank you, sir. There is another question that the bauxite prices recently corrected around \$60 per ton in February. So what could be the driver for that and from current level, how do you see pricing trends evolving? Like what kept demand supply dynamics that you could see?

Manan Shah: I think —I think we've covered this couple of times on the call. We mentioned the resumption of mines and we also mentioned the temporary halt of increase in smelting capacity in China. Only I think the comment is that we feel that things may improve, you know, if there is some geopolitical stability and maybe, you know, after the Chinese New Year.

But I think we have already covered the reasons for the fall and also potential reasons for stabilization.

So, I think —I don't think I have anything much new to add on that. I think we just want to wait for the, you know, Chinese New Year and see if there is some stabilization in this US-China policy, which will have some kind of an impact on manufacturing industry in China.

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Daisy Barocha: Okay. Thank you, sir. And one last question, sir. According to you, what bauxite price level would you consider the business approaching economic

floor? Like beyond what threshold would you reassess your capacity?

Manan Shah: I think that given that this price crash of bauxite has happened probably within the last month and a half or if you go to see, it's very early to comment on what would be the new normal. However, we are optimistic that we don't think prices will go below this level. So I can at least offer that much that—that prices I don't think should go below the current levels.

I do believe that this is some sort of a floor because we also see the costing of the other companies who are working in Guinea and we think this is a low level for the stabilization. Maybe in the medium term, I think a few dollars from here upwards could be the new normal.

Maybe a -- I mean, we believe about 64, 65, but nowadays commodity markets are quite difficult to predict as I think world over this is going on that there is lot of volatility in all commodity prices. But at least we feel that floor can be very close to where we are.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Pushkar Jain from Milli Capital. Please go ahead.

Pushkar Jain: Hi, sir. Thanks for the opportunity. I just wanted to ask about the —you mentioned that there are long-term contracts with ocean vessels. So, like what percentage of those are like fixed-rate multi-year contracts versus how much we remain exposed to, you know, bauxite index or changes in the freight rates?

Manan Shah: So, these are fixed in the sense that that we have a long-term agreement when I say long-term, I think it's like 12 months, okay, not maybe three years or something. But this long-term agreement is giving us an edge in terms of the rate maybe there may be some like variable with the price of the freight index, but it is basically at a rate lower than the market rate.

So it will remain lower than the market rate, but there may be obviously it will vary as per the market rate. It will vary as per the market rate, but there is some discount in this freight compared to the going market rate. So this is giving us a significant support and this is also one of our at least a quite a lot of our volume is covered under this contract.

So, while the rate will vary, it is below the index rate, and against that, the shipping company is also getting a sustained business. So, the agreement is that, you know, the volumes are committed, the prices can move around, but on the basic idea is that it will be a little bit below the index price through the year.

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Pushkar Jain: Okay. So only if there is like huge fluctuation...

Manan Shah: And that is a significant part of the —significant part of our total targeted business for next year is under this contract. So we will be having some advantage in freight compared to the market for this coming year, and that will also help us with our cost.

Pushkar Jain: Okay. But if —okay, I got it. And second question is about the iron ore, so what is the average Fe content now of the ore that is being currently extracted?

Manan Shah: So basically, we are supplying to the beneficiation plant, so our grade is a very medium grade, which is why it requires a beneficiation. Approximately we are around 45 to 50. And but this is beneficiatable, right, like it's improvable. There are some iron ore grades which are maybe higher but they are not possible to improve easily.

Ours is fairly relatively easy to improve. So our I think focus would be on the volume, there may be a recovery percentage or a yield percentage at the beneficiation plant, but the point is that all of it is exportable. Only there may be the few kilometers of distance where we may be sending some quantity to the plant and over there may be some yield.

But eventually all of this will be going as a really good quality iron ore when it's exported. Right.

And... While the quality sounds 4

5 to 50, but it is easily upgradable. It crosses 60, 61 after beneficiation. So it's just a the play on the yield.

Pushkar Jain: Okay. And the volumes in FY '27 we expect from iron ore would be?

Manan Shah: So, we have not commented on that very consciously. We are still doing trials to understand that the, you know, what is the viability for the partner who we have on this project, but we should be able to comment on that at the end of this quarter.

Pushkar Jain: Thanks a lot.

Manan Shah: We are optimistic that this will be a fairly substantial quantity even in the context of the Guinea business, but exact figures or in terms of what kind of volume target we can see, I think we should be able to definitely comment on that at the end of this quarter.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Udit Mittal from Mittal Family Office. Please go ahead.

Udit Mittal: Yes. So, I just wanted to understand, are you facing any competition from the other players? Like are there any order cancellation or anything like that?

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Manan Shah: They are asking if we are seeing any order cancellation or heavy competition from the other players.

Chetan Shah: No, not really. There is no any order cancellation. And there is no actually looking this thing, there is no much new competition also. You know, that we have our volume, we already have our customers for that, only the price to be negotiated on basis of the index price. So do not much concern about the volume, which we able to achieve, and the price also, it's definitely has a linked with the index. So we don't see that there will be any impact of the cancellation of business or any stringent competition.

Udit Mittal: And are the customers delaying the contract or something like that due to the price fall?

Chetan Shah: Not really. See, if you ask me, then it would be China is being the largest importer of bauxite in the world. And sometimes, it's being some kind of mutual understanding among the customers or among the receivers to play a some kind of strategy to maintain the price. Because at one time the bauxite price has touched \$120 also.

So now it is a some understanding among the major producers or something. So that they try to control it, but there is no —they also understand that the cost structures, they're very familiar with the operations in Guinea So there is not much impact on this thing, and I —we —as Manan mentioned that it is already a floor. It's —it's not going to be now below this kind of numbers.

Udit Mittal: Okay. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question is from the line of Vardhaman Sancheti from AVS Group. Please go ahead.

Vardhaman Sancheti: Hi, sir. What is your floor level below which you need to reconsider the production volumes?

Manan Shah: What is our floor price at which we may choose to not operate if it goes below \$50?

Chetan Shah: Yes. If it is below \$52, maybe then we have to reconsider our stand. Otherwise, we'll —will be very comfortable till that number. So because, you know, there is a different kind of situation. Uh, one of our mining concession is very close to the port where the viability at even that price is also possible. And one concession is slightly away from the port. So then we have to decide that what kind of compositions we have to or to product mix we have to do. But otherwise viability, yes, the business viability below 52 is definitely a concern.

Manan Shah: So we have -- I just want to share add on that, that we do have some ability to mitigate this like whether it is through the freight or it is through the managing the -- because we have the two current active resources, by managing the distribution between the resources which we have. We also have

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a scope of improving the qualiti

y to get the premium over the market price. So it is a while I understand that optically okay the price drop is very significant but company does have the tools . And we are today backed by the very large amount of resource and reserves. So it does give us a ability to tide out certain such phases even like my father mentioned at lower prices -- we do have some tools. And the other thing we would like to mention is that Ashapura Group has been in the bauxite business as such for over 20 years now. So we also have a good relationships with many of these customers.

So things like cancelling the order or trying to do a too much of a unnecessary tactics or negotiation, this kind of situation we are -- even if we will do 15 million tons or something, so we will still be about 8 %-10% of the China's bauxite import. So we are quite confident that in this kind of period also we should able to maintain our volume plan and we do have some of the tools to mitigate to some extent the lower prices of bauxite support.

Vardhaman Sancheti: Okay. So just consider suppose general bauxite price is 60 and you told we have premium quality bauxite. So if you can quantify that premium quality is selling at 63 or 65, what premium ?

Manan Shah: So typically it would be anywhere between \$1 to \$2 - \$2.5 depending on how much premium we are offering over the over the index alumina. So that depends on that. So but it can be not -- it's not going to be like \$ 5 or something, but it could be up to a \$2.5 is possible what we can get.

Vardhaman Sancheti: All right. So with the port upgradations and everything --

Manan Shah: I mean, I think we can pause this question. I mean, with -- because a general comment is there probably, but like...

Vardhaman Sancheti: One last question from my side. So like we have one source country like Guinea and we have one customer country as China. So over the years, are we looking for any significant diversion in terms of product mix or geographical mix?

Manan Shah: I think that we are open. We are definitely open and we do have a lot of studies also, but currently as on today it is entirely based on the majorly based on the China. But -- we can see, like we mentioned maybe something may come up in Middle East or even in India there may be some significant requirement. Canada also has got something. Now US also want to restart. All these locations may still see, I know that there are locations nearby, but there may be some...

It's too early to comment but maybe once we reach a certain amount of volume -- and other products as well in other products, iron ore. For the time being, I can comment on iron ore. We do study things time-to-time but our commercial interest currently is limited to bauxite and iron ore in Guinea.

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Vardhaman Sancheti: All right. And when the alumina players like ramping up the capacity up from China, outside China, by which year we can expect?

Manan Shah: I think currently...

Chetan Shah: They already started. In Indonesia, they have started some activities in Middle East.

Manan Shah: So yes, as my father mentioned, I don't know if you all caught that, is Indonesia and Middle East certain we are seeing some activity. But the point is that fundamentally the smelter capacity needs to come up. The refinery capacity is available. So the smelter capacity would pull up ...

Vardhaman Sancheti: I'm asking for smelter only.

Manan Shah: You mentioned. Okay. Yes . So we think that yes , we should expect maybe over a couple of years something to either come up in Indonesia, Malaysia or Middle East. That's what we are looking at least...

Management: The power arbitrage here.

Manan Shah: Yes. Middle East has certain pockets which has a very low power cost, which could make it a ideal location for having a smelter which consumes lot of power per ton of aluminum production.

Moder

ator: Our next question comes from the line of Kriti Tripathi from NVS Brokerage.

Nalin Shah: Yes. Can you -- this is Nalin Shah from NVS Brokerage. Can you tell us this -- I think in the current nine months we have done about 4.77 million export. Considering I mean the fourth quarter is likely to be I think much, much better, can you tell us that -- what is the target for the current year, total exports? You also mentioned about 27- 28 to be 15 million tons. So what will be the target for the '26-'27, next year?

Manan Shah: So good. Thank you, Nalin Bhai. Basically , I think for quarter four at least what I can comment is that we expect it to be a record quarter four for us as from a Guinea quarterly export point of view.

Exact numbers obviously yes , would refrain to share. And like I mentioned, we see a linear progression that okay, so I think that it would be that okay, 15 million being year after next year would be somewhere around would be somewhere halfway between this year and 15. So wherever we close, we should...

Nalin Shah: Can we put around say 11 and a half, 12 -- 12 million?

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Manan Shah: Yes. We hope so. We even hope for more, but I'll not be in a position to say anything, but we are internally very aggressive for ramping up in this basically for us the quarter four and quarter one are the best quarters. So our entire focus is on execution and volume. Yes.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Samir Patel from Savy Capital.

Samir Patel: I just wanted to touch upon the debt part. You said your most of your capex is done in Guinea. So how do you see the debt over the next two years?

Manan Shah: We expect at least that the debt is close to its peak or at peak really. We -- however, in the interest of growing the business, we may take little bit of time before we gradually start to retire the debt because as the volume grows, so will the working capital needs. And like we mentioned still there is a 20 %-25% capex left over.

While we may be able to manage that entirely from internal accrual, we do think we are close to our peak debt and definitely we might be here for some time, but gradually we expect maybe that after a year or so gradually we can start reducing the debt. But currently we don't see the addition of debt -- at least as of now I don't foresee that there will be a further addition of debt.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of CA Amitesh Mandowara from Amitesh Mandowara & Company.

Amitesh Mandowara: Thank you for the opportunity, Manan Bhai, I have one question for you. Given the current aluminum prices and China demand trend, do you expect alumina producers to restock the bauxite inventories once again? Has there been any notable alumina capacity expansion or ramp-up in China or globally?

Manan Shah: Currently my impression of the inventory levels of bauxite in China is that while the prices of bauxite are lower, we see that inventory is more or less not increased significantly or there is a pile-up of stock or something like that. We think inventory is close to its -- you know, regular levels is, what it is currently ...

Chetan Shah: The inventory in China at the moment is all-time low. So Chinese will start the buying the -- having the new inquiries or new business after they are all waiting for the this Spring Festival after the Chinese New Year, because the last information is that its inventory level at Chinese port is all-time low at the moment.

Amitesh Mandowara: Okay. Even I have the same information. That is why I am asking that do you expect alumina producer to restock bauxite inventory in coming quarter?

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Chetan Shah: Yes. Yes. Certainly, this is -- as I mentioned earlier so some kind of strategic planning by the large producers. The

y now again they have to improve the inventory because normally they should have the inventory for minimum period of four months of their production. Because any kind of eventualities can happen political, geopolitical or some kind of, Yes, climatic, many -- many changes can happen.

So they normally, because, alumina refinery is such that it is a continuous process industries where you cannot afford to stop for few days and you restart and all. The restarting cost is so high, that's why they very, very particular and very clear about having the sufficient inventory to meet all these challenges.

Amitesh Mandowara: Okay. And do your long-term contracts include any base or floor price to protect the -- protect against this current spot price correction in bauxite?

Manan Shah: We are -- we are linked to the index.

Amitesh Mandowara: Okay.

Manan Shah: Yes.

Amitesh Mandowara: Thank you.

Manan Shah: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Krish from Mangal Keshav. Please go ahead.

Krish: Hello. Good afternoon. It was a great set of numbers. I just have a question on the Indian business.

As Indian business has been -- has given a support when bauxite price will remain volatile, Indian business can on a consolidated level give support to the overall business. And as there has some surplus upside in input cost increase over this quarter, how does the Indian business looks forward, and if in the next coming quarters if it can give some support if there could be a headwind in the bauxite business?

Manan Shah: So the question, I assume is just on the outlook of the Indian business and its consistency to be maintained. I am genuinely quite excited about our Indian business from a medium-term even not long-term, but even medium-term standpoint as we are bringing many new products, and we are, just bringing many of these products to commercialize.

And gradually I do think that India will remain kind of a business where we continue to add value and improve the sales, work

very limited in India. And over the long term we do see, even on the cost side we are taking many initiatives to continuously reduce the cost. So I think the fact remains that Ashapura Group has seen lot of volatility in the bauxite business .

But our Indian business has always been a source of strength and consolidation for us. And not only will that maintain, but it will also grow quite significantly over the next two to three years. It just so happens that because Guinea is a large part of our consolidated turnover, so sometimes the visibility remains limited. But I am very bullish on our positioning, our products, and our future product pipeline. Yes.

Krish: So the input cost which we have faced recently would somewhat mitigate over the coming years?

Manan Shah: Yes. We are working on lowering our specific consumption, creating alternate sources and creating far value-added products which can absorb some of this cost. Of course, yes, the manufacturing as a business in general don't have the overnight kind of improvements in this thing, but over a long term India will remain very, very strong pillar for the company.

Krish: Okay. Thank you so much.

Manan Shah: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question is from the line of Kush Bafna from Bafna Brothers Finance & Property Agent. Please go ahead.

Kush Bafna: Thank you, sir, for this opportunity, and congratulations on the quarterly performance. Sir, I had a couple of questions. First was that , you have mentioned the Indian business had suffered, due to increase in lower margin products. So can you throw some light on the same? I know that you have mentioned on excess costs, but also lower margin increase in Indian business?

Manan Shah: Yes. So we

have a basically a product portfolio which caters to about 10 industries. We have the four major verticals in our businesses , both through shareholding and directly operating in the standalone company. And across this , even at the very major level we have about 40, 50 different types of products which we sell across, paint, paper, edible oil, crude oil, steel, non -ferrous metals, construction, foundry, etcetera.

So it so happens that -- that we had a lot more of a lower value shipments also, like a kind of some kind of a bulk businesses etcetera in a couple of our businesses. And maybe the higher value products had a little bit of a lower shipment. So not in full, but definitely to some extent , if I see the lower EBITDA or the lower, results compared to previous quarter, at least I would say that 30% of that -- I'm just giving a kind of approximate number -- would be also because the matrix has changed.

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And then I think , that this over the year this things also sometimes averages out, that some quarters goes better and some quarters goes in terms of the matrix and some quarters goes this thing. Today unfortunately in terms of from an investor standpoint, we are catering to so many different industries that to highlight the every industry-specific performance gets difficult. But matrix is something I think it evens out over the year.

Structurally I don't think that that matrix will be permanently like okay that the lower margin products will come up. Cost increases yes, of course, more critical. We are working on strategy , like I think earlier we announced that two of our mines had come into operation. This kind of also activities reduces our cost as we improve our integration. So further such things are happening and we'll be happy to share it with you as it happens. But we have to definitely work on our cost-related part and we are focused on it to improve that. Yes .

Kush Bafna: Thank you. And one more question, sir. This was regarding the related party exposure. I think more than 70% of our loans and advances and around 71% of our investments are to related parties. They have their own auditors and some of them -- some of these subsidiaries have been making losses. Could you throw some light on the same?

Manan Shah: I think Ashish bhai can comment and then if required we can comment further.

Ashish Desai: Yes. You are right. I mean related party transactions are there, but be assured, I mean , it's all are within limit and with prior approval of the board, shareholders wherever it is required. And wherever it is operation need to do that transaction. So loans and advances also well within the limit and it's complied by each and every law which we are supposed to.

Manan Shah: Just operationally also today you can see that which is publicly declared information that we have a holding structure for our Guinea business. It involves, subsidiaries from India to UAE and then from UAE onwards to Guinea. This is a well -- we have fairly disclosed this thing, it's quite well known. So obviously there are a structure wherein, there is a some activity which happens from India to UAE

to Guinea .

Even though it is 100% held by Ashapura and vice versa. So even to give you an example, lot of purchases, of materials like capex and engineering items happens through India which eventually reaches Guinea and things like this. So there are many transactions required, to support the business, but these are ultimately consolidated many of them, most of them within the group itself and most of them with the 100% subsidiaries or the well-established subsidiaries with the arm's length and relevant documentation etcetera.

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So there -- this is a more like the nature of the structure rather than anything else. So you -- yes, you can rest assure

d that it's well -- well within the requirement , and it's only because of the requirement of the business and the business structure which we carry.

Kush Bafna: Right, sir. Thank you for clarifying that and wishing you all the best for record quarter next year. Thank you.

Manan Shah: Thank you so much, Kush. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question is from the line of Pranjant, an Individual Investor . Please go ahead.

Our next question is from the line of Prasad Kanodia, an Individual Investor. Please go ahead. Mr. Kanodia, your line has been unmuted. Please go ahead with your question. Sir, as there is no response, can we conclude?

Manan Shah: Yes.

Moderator: I would now like to hand the conference over to Mr. Chetan Shah for closing comments. Over to you, sir.

Manan Shah: So I can just give the closing comments. Just that we would like to say that yes, the in for the Guinea business, the bauxite pricing has been a setback, but the company remains confident to tide through this time with variety of initiatives and options at its hand. We are also fundamentally optimistic about the nature of the business and that gradually we do expect a price recovery as well. You want to add dad

Chetan Shah: See my friends and stakeholders, I like to tell you that this business, like the this reserves, the bauxite reserves is last for 50 years. And we look at the quarter on quarter, they will give you a fair picture and sometime unfair pictures. So we want to see that how best we utilize our resources and how best we can -- we can bring into the effective business.

So this is what we are planning this thing. Yes . It's going to happen, that's now a lot of climatic changes, the geopolitical instability, but the demand of this minerals or demand of the ultimate the metals is going to remain very high. It's the aluminum metal per se is going on CAGR of the 7%, and this is going to go much higher than that , because once the more and more EV production will happen, that will attract the consumption, aerospace, the defense, and many other areas, this metal is going to have a long-term future.

So I have only simple things to say to all of you is that we have to see the a long-term prospective of this business not on basically on quarter -on-quarter. However, we appreciate your interest, we appreciate your concern about the Ashapura and it gives us a lot of motivations and encouragement,

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to improve on our performance and to keep you in touch. Thank you very much all of you. Thank you.

Manan Shah: Yes. Thank you, everyone. Thank you, everyone. Thanks a lot and looking forward to meeting you all again after three months.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Ashapura Minechem Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.